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1. Overview

This game supports up to six players and is set in the era of the Industrial Revolution from the mid-19th to the early 20th century. The explosive growth of capitalism and economic globalization provided the material foundation for imperialist expansion, while the awakening of nationalism profoundly reshaped international politics. Through diplomacy and military interaction with one another, players can experience the intense conflicts and strategic contests of the era. Through continuous competition and cooperation, players can carve out their own path to victory amid rapidly shifting circumstances.

2. Game Interface

The game interface consists of the following components:

- Main Map
- Diplomacy Chart
- Score Track
- Progress Track
- Player Panel
- Recovery Area
- Round & Phase Track

2.1. Main Map

The main map is the most crucial component of the game which covers Europe, Africa, and Asia. On the main map, players may give most of the political and military commands, including moving troops, moving warships and apply/reduce influences.

Land is divided into several contiguous blocks, collectively called "regions". Regions are connected by solid lines or dash lines, which indicates that armies can move across these adjacent regions; solid lines impose no extra effects, while the dash lines, which is known as "Difficult Paths", made of hills or deserts, impose the following effects:

- Not allowed to deploy over Difficult Paths
- The Ops is double when moving across the path
- Gives attackers a negative modifier

The sea is divided into several contiguous areas, collectively called “sea zones”. Some sea zones are separated by straits or canals, such as the Strait of Gibraltar between the Atlantic and the West Mediterranean, the Dardanelles between the East Mediterranean and the Black Sea, the Danish Straits and the Kiel Canal between the Baltic and the Atlantic, and the Suez Canal between the East Mediterranean and the Red Sea.

2.1.1. Europe

All European regions are displayed on the main map. Territories ranging from Dublin in the far west to Moscow in the east, and from Helsinki in the north to Gibraltar and Malta in the south fall within the scope of Europe. Due to the unique status of the Ottoman state, the Anatolian Peninsula, including Constantinople, İzmir, Ankara and Adana, is classified as part of Europe.

Nations on the Scandinavian Peninsula and the Iberian Peninsula are excluded from the game, as they possessed low levels of political engagement within the timeframe covered by the game.

Some areas are specifically marked:

- South Slavic regions: including Trieste, Zagreb, Sarajevo, Belgrade, and Sofia.
- German States: including Hannover, Leipzig, Stuttgart, Munich.
- Italian States: including Florence, Rome, Naples.

European countries serve as the primary targets for players’ political and diplomatic activities. European countries, defined as those whose capital lies within Europe, are categorised into Great Powers, Major Powers and Minor Powers.

States are special. They do not belong to any category above, and they do not have any diplomatic interaction with players either.

2.1.2. Africa

Africa is separated from Europe by the Western Mediterranean and Eastern Mediterranean; the dividing line between the two continents runs across the Strait of Gibraltar and the Strait of Tunis. Africa is separated from Asia by the Suez Canal.

Africa is split into North Africa and Sub-Saharan Africa. North Africa is geographically closer to Europe and Asia, while Sub-Saharan Africa lies to the south of North Africa, connected to North Africa on land only via Egypt–Sudan.

Countries within Africa are either independent insignificant powers or colonies belonging to European powers. Players’ diplomatic actions in Africa center on conquest: players gain colonies by increasing regional influence or claiming sovereignty.

2.1.3. Asia

Asia is separated from Europe by the Ural Mountains, the Caucasus Mountains and the Armenian Highland–Taurus Mountains. Asia is separated from Africa by the Suez Canal.

Asia is divided into Central Asia (encompassing West Asia in the geographical sense) and China. Central Asia sits closer to Europe and North Africa, while China lies further east, connected to Central Asia solely via off-map regions and off-map sea zones.

Like Africa, countries in Central Asia are either independent insignificant powers or colonies belonging to European powers. Players, particularly Britain and Russia, pursue conquest within Central Asia.
The China region cannot be accessed through conventional means. Only upon triggering the effect of situation cards may Great Powers enter China and engage in combat with China or Japan. After the *Open Door Policy* takes effect, China generates Trade Value for all Great Powers, yet remains unconquerable.

2.2. Diplomacy Chart

To track the diplomatic status between Great Powers, and to track the Guarantee of Independence between Great Powers and Major Powers.
A single "Contest Goal/War Goal" marker may be placed on the Diplomacy Chart by Prussia/Germany or Austria/Austria-Hungary to represent the special conflict for German Leadership. A counter is used to track the progress of this war.
German Unification Track and Italian Unification Track mark the circumstances of Prussia, Austria and Italy in these areas. They also indicate the goals required to push the progress and the bonus, and they record the states annexed. When any power's progress reaches 3, the corresponding track will no longer be used.
Note: If the goal is no longer met, the progress will go backwards. The bonus on the track can only be collected once.

2.3. Score Track

2.3.1. Total Victory Points (VP)

To track the total Victory Points each Great Power obtains. This determines which player(s) will win the game.

2.3.2. Technology

To track each Great Power's technological progress.
The Technology track features Command Points and Bonus Points. Once a Great Power's Command Points reach the end, Command Points are immediately cleared. Advance the power's Bonus Points by 1, and then increase their Technology Victory Points and Industrial Cap by 1.

2.3.3. Progress track

To track the occurrence and progress of events. The following three listed will impact and even reshape the geopolitical landscape.

- Baghdad Railway
- Suez Canal
- African Colonial Disputes

2.4. Player Panel

Each player has two panels: VP Board and Economy Board. Here are the introduction and procedures in details to interact with them.

2.4.1. VP Board

VP Board is used to place markers related to Victory Points and conduct special missions.

- When owning a new region, including dual-core region, province and colony. Follow the instructions of the board when placing the corresponding markers.
- When losing a region, hand the marker back to the main map or over to another player.
- Some VPs you obtain by unconventional means should be placed in “Extra Bonus VP” block.
- When some circumstances affect your VP, you need to focus on it by moving or flipping your markers according to the scenario.
- No matter how the above affects your VP, move your VP counter along the track.

2.4.2. Economy Board

Economy Board is used to track your Industry and Trade:

- When obtaining Industry markers (recovery, adding a cap or owning a new region), put the industry markers on the board to the left as possible as you can; when losing the industry markers (mobilizing, building a battleship or losing a region), take them away from the right to the left.
- When building a battleship, take it from “Warships in Reserve”, and then move an industry marker from the “industry value” slot to where the battleship leaves; when the battleship is destroyed, take an industry marker from the “Warships in Reserve” slot to Recovery Area, and then move the destroyed battleship to that slot. Either a battleship or an industry marker should be placed in each slot at “Warships in Reserve”, as it cannot be empty.
- Consider the break or attrition to your trade when calculating your Trade Value during Draw Phase, and move the counter along the trade track.
- In Draw Phase, draw cards according to your Industry Value and Trade Value respectively. The text on the right of the last marker (from left to right) indicates the number of cards to draw.

2.5. Recovery Area

The Conscripts of Great Powers, Major Powers and Minor Powers will be placed in Recovery Area when they are eliminated. In Recovery Phase, these Conscripts will return to Economy Board (Great Powers) or the region of Main Map (Major Power and Minor Power).

2.6. Round & Phase Track

To track the ongoing Round and Phase of the game.

3. Regions and Sea Zones

3.1. Regions

Each region is part of the economic system. Meanwhile, as regions provide Victory Points, they are often the focus of competition among players.

A region is illustrated with a square or circle.

- **Industrial Region**. Square numerals: upright, showing the region's starting (1848) Industry Cap. Each industrial region's Industry cannot exceed the local cap, unless it is changed by situations, events and technology. All Industrial Regions are in Europe.



- **Trade Region**. Square numerals: script, showing the region's starting (1848) Trade Value. Each region's Trade Value can only be changed by situations and events. All Trade Regions are outside Europe.



- **Non-Industrial Region**. These regions are circle, providing no Industry, nor can they increase their Industry Cap. All dual-core regions are Non-Industrial Regions. They only exist in Europe



In addition, some regions have special functions:

- **Capital:** The most important region of a country (octagram); once it falls, the country may be forced to surrender unconditionally. Only Great Powers and Major Powers have their capital marked, because these powers have more than one region; Minor Powers' regions are seen as their own capitals. Only Major powers (instead of Great Powers) can have their capitals conceded while they still remain independent; when this country regains this region or becomes independent, it must move its capital here.



- **Port:** A region with a port can host naval units and allows the controller to build warships there. For trade and naval movement, a port region is considered connected to adjacent sea zones; if there are two ports in a region, it is considered connected to both sea zones adjacent to the region.
- **Strait:** The controller of a region with a strait can effectively block other powers' warships from crossing between sea zones and cut off trade routes.

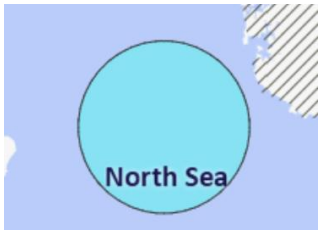


- **Canal:** A region with a canal makes sea zones connected after the canal is opened, and then the canal functions the same as the strait. Before the Suez Canal is opened, the East Mediterranean and Red Sea are not connected; before the Kiel Canal is opened, the North Sea and the Baltic Sea are connected only via the Danish Straits (Copenhagen).



- **Fortress:** Gives a modifier to the defending units. Players may build a fortress in a region only by playing *Build Fortifications*.

3.2. Sea Zones



Sea Zones do not only provide access for military units, but also associate with Trade Routes, making them essential part of the economy.

A Sea Zone is connected to the port regions nearby. Sea Zones can be connected to each other.

Whatever it is army or navy, the Ops they spend crossing a Sea Zone are the same as crossing a Region, which means that transporting over Sea Zones is more effective.

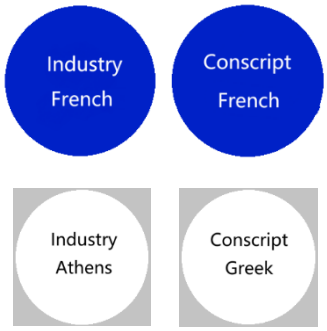
As Sea Zones are public, a Great Power's Trade Route can go over multiple Sea Zones; even at war, warships from different sides may exist in a Sea Zone. When a power has battleship(s), it may launch a Naval attack to seize the Sea Control to cut off their enemy's Trade Route (at this moment, the Sea Zone is no longer open for their enemy).

4. Markers

4.1. Industry and Military Units

4.1.1. Industry/Conscript

"Industry/Conscript" are units of Great Powers, Major Powers and Minor Powers. The "Industry/Conscript" markers of Great Powers and Major Powers are colored, while those of Minor Powers are not.



The front side of a "Industry/Conscript" represents the industry for economic production, while the back is used as a unit of conscripted troops.

Once a "Industry/Conscript" marker enters the game, it will never be removed. A Great Power's total Industry Caps is the sum of the Industry Cap from each region they own. The number of "Industry/Conscript" markers they hold cannot exceed the total Caps they have.

This marker can only be used in:

a) Economy. Set as industrial input to increase the potential income of hand cards.
b) Army. Converted from industry to conscripted troops during Action Phase, to be used as battle force or occupy regions.
c) Navy. Spent as the maintenance cost for a battleship.

"Industry/Conscript" is the most essential resource. The higher Industry Caps a Great Power hold, the more cards they can draw or the more units they can maintain.

As each Great Power has their Conscripts with colors, it is not difficult to distinguish which power these units belong to. **Note**, both Prussia/Germany and Austria/AH take German as

their primary ethnicity, despite their "Industry/Conscript" with different colors. When they annex a German State, you need to replace the local "Industry/Conscript" marker with the color of the owner.

When Major Power or Minor Power is independent, their "Industry/Conscript" markers all placed either on their corresponding regions on Main Map or in Recovery Area, with "Conscript" side up; When they are not independent, these markers are either on Great Power's Economy Board or as Ottoman's non-core region with "Industry" side up.
For States, the "Industry" side is up.

4.1.2. Reservist



Reservists are special units of Great Powers. Instead of being converted from Industry, they join the game via events, such as *Canadian Corps*. If a reservist on Main Map is eliminated, it will be removed from Main Map.
There is an upper limit on each Great Power's Reservists. The number of reservists they hold on Main Map cannot exceed the maximum number given by this boardgame.
Compared to conscripts, reservists have a weaker combat ability, but they are not recruited at the cost of economic income.

4.1.3. Neutral Unit



Insignificant Powers and Other Powers take "Neutral Unit" as their army. These units may join the game via events. If a neutral unit is eliminated, it will be removed from Main Map.
At the start of the game (1848 & 1872 scenario), Ottoman Empire has a certain number of Neutral Units. When Ottoman is at war with Great Power, these neutral units are seen as Ottoman's local force.

4.1.4. Battleship

Battleships are the main force of navy which provide superior firepower. They can destroy enemy's warships in the sea battle, and they can also seize the sea control. These are the features of Battleship:

- Highly durable. During the sea battle, it requires two hits to destroy a battleship, while one hit is only sufficient to damage it. The front side of the "battleship" marker is in perfect condition, and the back is in damage condition. The firepower is weaker in damage condition. In perfect condition, a battleship is flipped over when being hit once; a damaged battleship is destroyed when being hit another time.
- Damaged battleships are flipped over to their front side when back to ports.
- Building a battleship costs a lot, and you need an Industry marker of your core for trade. Before the battleship is destroyed, the traded industry marker remains where the ship had been on the Economy Board, which is regarded as the necessary monetary costs and manpower to maintain the ship. Destroyed battleships should be

placed back on Economy Board, and the industry marker there should be put into Recovery Area.

4.1.5. Frigate

Frigates are weaker than Battleships. They have no firepower but provide shields for Battleships. These are the features of Frigates:

- During the sea battle, if the number of frigates is no less than battleships, then frigates take damages first.
- Frigates can operate independently. When doing so, they cannot seize the sea control but block their enemies' army deployment, army movement and amphibious assault.
- The front side of the "frigate" marker represents 1 unit of frigate, and the back side represents 2 units of frigates. It requires only one hit to destroy a unit of frigate.
- Building a frigate costs little. When building a frigate, or when a frigate is destroyed, just move them between the Economy Board and Main Map.

4.2. Zone Control/Ownership

Each Great Power has plenty of "Own/Control" markers. The head side indicates the ownership of a region, while the tail side indicates the control of a region or sea control of a sea zone.

Ownership:



The legal claim to a region. Only diplomatic treaties or claiming sovereignty over Insignificant Powers can change ownership. Changes in ownership affect Victory Points. When a Great Power or Ottoman owns their **non-core** region or their dual-core region, use the hexagonal "Own" marker to indicate ownership; when owning your **core** region, you do not need to place this marker.

Control:



Temporarily occupation of the region. Players need to spend Ops to control a region with their troops. Moreover, controlling your enemy's region will stop them obtaining Trade Value or mobilizing, and further prevent them suppressing revolts; when controlling your enemy's region, the fort there provide you with modifier. When controlling your enemy's region, place "Control" marker there to indicate your status of control.

To summarize, a region's ownership and control are separated. By default, control of a region aligns with ownership; while during wartime, control could change.
During the war, when you control a region not owned by you, place your "Control" marker; when you withdraw from the war, you must clear your control during the war, clear your enemy's control of your owned region, and execute the armistice that changes ownership.

Sea Control:

Sea Control can only be used in a Sea Zone. When launching a naval attack and winning the

battle, place your “Control” on the sea zone.
As Sea Zone is open to all powers, you will remove your enemy’s sea control and cut off their trade route when seizing the sea control. But this will not influence those neutral powers.

4.3. Regional Bonus

4.3.1. German/Italian State



There are multiple independent states in German and Italian regions at the start of 1848 scenario. Keep the “State” marker on the independent regions yet united to indicate their ownership.
“State” markers will not directly bring you any VPs when you own those regions. However, by conquering these states, you can move these markers to VP Board to record the number of your core regions yet to claim to unite your country.

4.3.2. Dual-core Region





For certain countries, owning a dual-core region gives VP. After obtaining the ownership of a dual-core region, move this regional VP from Main Map or VP Board to another player’s VP Board.
Some “Dual-Core Region” markers have the other side “Owned by X”, such as Kiel owned by Denmark.

4.3.3. Province





When Major Power or Minor Power’s core region is owned by themselves, place the marker on Main Map with “Independent” side up.
When Major Power or Minor Power’s core region is owned by a Great Power, place the marker into the Great Power’s VP Board with “Province” side up. If it is an industrial region, move the corresponding “Industry” markers from Main Map or VP Board to another player’s VP Board. The number of Industry is equal to the local Industry Cap.

4.3.4. Colony





When Insignificant Power’s core region is owned by themselves, place the marker on Main Map with “Independent” side up.
When Insignificant Power’s core region is owned by a Great Power, place the marker into the Great Power’s VP Board with “Colony” side up. During Draw Phase, the local Trade Value is counted into the new owner’s economy.

4.4. Diplomatic Markers

4.4.1. Contest Goal/War Goal

"Contest Goal" is usually played during Diplomacy Phase, to claim a diplomatic demand. When this demand is not solved, a contest will upgrade to a war. At this moment, the "Contest Goal" is flipped to the side "War Goal". In quite a few circumstances, a war might start in Situation Phase or Action Phase.
The position where such a "Goal" marker lies on Main Map is associated with the war target. A war never ends if its "War Goal" still remains on Main Map.
Each Great Power has one "Contest Goal/War Goal" markers.

4.4.2. For/Against

Great Powers play "For/Against" during Diplomacy Phase, to intervene other powers' contests or wars.
For: side with the one who played "Contest Goal/War Goal", or literally the initiator of the war.
Against: fight against the one who played "Contest Goal/War Goal", or literally the defender in the war.
Each Great Power has one "Contest Goal/War Goal" markers.

4.4.3. Alliance/Truce

"Alliance/Truce" marker is placed in Diplomacy Chart to denote the diplomatic status between two countries.
Two Great Powers may simultaneously hold both Alliance and Truce status; simply stack the two markers in such cases.

4.4.4. Guarantee of Independence

"Guarantee of Independence" marker may be placed between a Great Power and a Major Power, to denote a special status.
This status can only exist between certain powers. The Ottoman Empire may receive a Guarantee of Independence from either Prussia/Germany or Britain, while Romania may receive a Guarantee of Independence from either Russia or Austria/Austria-Hungary.

4.5. Extra Bonus VP

Except for obtaining more provinces and colonies, Great Power may receive bonus VP by meeting requirements or triggering card events.

4.5.1. General Bonus VP

Some Bonus VPs from card events are attainable for all players. These VP markers are colored white, which means that they can be triggered by any player.
Some other Bonus, such as by building Suez Canal, can only be triggered by specific countries. Their Bonus VP markers are colored in both sides.



4.5.2. Special (Power) Bonus VP

Some Bonus VPs can only be obtained by certain Great Power when they complete a mission. Their markers are colored the same as that power. When acquiring these Bonus VPs, put them into "Bonus VP" area from VP Board.
Some other VPs are recorded by moving counters along the track. When acquiring these VPs, just leave the counter there and keep updating that player's VPs.

4.6. Other Markers

Other markers have different functions.
For example:
When collecting bonus from technology or triggering an event, place "+1/+2 Industry Cap" markers on the corresponding region on Main Map.
When successfully applying influences, place "+1/+2 influence" markers on the corresponding Insignificant Power or Minor Power on Main Map.





5. Power & Ethnicity

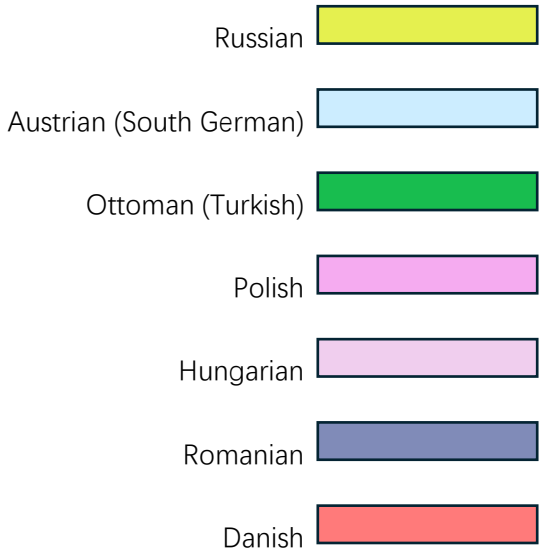
The powers (countries) in the game are divided into Great Powers, Major Powers, Minor Powers, Insignificant Powers, and some Other Powers.
Great Powers, Major Powers and Minor Powers have independent political rights in diplomacy and hold equal standing during negotiations. In another word, to conquer these opponents, Great Powers must spend Ops and declare a war officially. While Insignificant Powers and Other Powers are not the target of diplomacy.
Great Powers and Major Powers' core regions and country-specific markers & counters are colored differently.

British

French

German (North German)

Italian



When these colors are shown on the regions of Main Map, they represent the local ethnicity of the region; markers and tokens with these colors represent the country that the units or warships belong to.

5.1. Great Powers

Each of the six players controls one Great Power. The six Great Powers are Britain, France, Prussia (Germany), Sardinia (Italy), Russia, and Austria (Austria-Hungary).
During the entire Action Phase and some stages in End Phase, the six players act in order; in other phases, order can be ignored.
The order of turns is always as follows (the first to the last):

a) Britain
b) France
c) Prussia (Germany)
d) Sardinia (Italy)
e) Russia
f) Austria (Austria-Hungary)

These countries play an extremely important role in the game, as they can manipulate the geographical landscape of the world. They are the absolute protagonists in the plots.

5.2. Major Powers

Major Powers are the countries one tier lower than Great Powers. Major Power has at least two core regions (including dual-core regions). These Major Powers are:

- Ottoman Empire
- Poland
- Hungary
- Romania
- Denmark

Poland, Romania and Hungary are not independent at the start of the 1848 scenario. After

Austria/Hungary is formed, Hungary becomes another primary ethnicity of AH, and it will never be revolting or independent during the rest of the game.
The color of the "Industry/Conscript" of these countries is unique. Their Industry can be mobilized into troops.
Major Powers' core-regions owned by Great Powers are taken as "Provinces", which provide Industry Value but can also initiate a revolt.

5.3. Minor Powers

All those which have a (white) core region in Europe are Minor Powers. These Minor Powers, such as Belgium and Serbia, only have one core region, which is also their capital.
German and Italian States are considered Minor Powers before annexation.
The color of the "Industry/Conscript" of these countries is white, but their identity is specified with text. Their Industry can be mobilized into troops.
Minor Powers' core-regions owned by Great Powers are taken as "Provinces", which provide Industry Value but can also initiate a revolt.

5.4. Insignificant Powers

On Main map, non-European powers (except regions in China) are Insignificant Powers. Each independent region in Africa and Central Asia is treated as a separate political entity (Iran is a nation but taken as fragmented Insignificant Powers in the game).
The troops of these countries are represented with "Neutral Unit" tokens. This means that their troops are limited in numbers and cannot be increased via mobilization. When their regions are occupied by Great Powers, they are taken as "Colonies" and provide Trade Value for Great Powers.
As Insignificant Powers are weak in Diplomacy, Great Powers do not need to declare wars in Diplomacy Phase to conquer them. Great Powers can impose their influences to annex these colonies peacefully, or they can send their troops directly to these regions and then claim sovereignty.

5.5. States

All the independent powers inside "German States" or "Italian States" Area are States. These powers, such as Munich and Naples, have only one region. As States share the same ethnicity with Great Powers, their Industry can be mobilized into troops after annexation.
Alike Insignificant Powers, States are not involved in diplomacy. States have no army units, and Great Powers may not move their units into States' regions.
After State is annexed by Great Power, put its regional bonus marker to the Great Power's "Annexed States" area on Diplomacy Chart. If a German State is annexed, then the region will be either Prussian/German or Austrian core region instead of the other side's in the rest of the game.

5.6. Other Powers

Other Powers, including China, Japan, and Boers, are special in the game.

Chinese regions, including Beijing, Guangzhou, and Manchuria, cannot be invaded by Great Powers; Great Powers cannot send their troops to these regions. Only when *Opium Wars* or *Russo-Japanese War* is in effect, Great Powers' units may move there and control those regions.

Only when certain situation cards (*Russo-Japanese War* or *Boers Wars*) take in effect, Japanese or Boers' units will launch an attack to the regions on Main Map.

5.7. Ethnicity

Each European region illustrates the ethnicity living there via its color; some regions have two colors (i.e. dual-core region), indicating that two ethnicities exist.

Each European country, including Great Power, Major Power and Minor Power, see only one ethnicity as their own primary ethnicity; after foundation, Austria-Hungary has two primary ethnicities.

Usually, each ethnicity, when taken as primary ethnicity, matches only one country, but there are two exceptions:

a) German is the primary ethnicity of both Prussia/Germany and Austria/Austria-Hungary. After being annexed, the region of a German State will be either Great Power's core region.

For Great Power, the regions they own can either be their:

- Core region (the region and the power's ethnicity share the same color); or
- Non-core region (the region and the power's ethnicity share the different color).

As Minor Power only has one region, the only region is their core region.

For each power, industry from their core regions can provide economic production or be mobilized into troops, while the industry from their non-core regions can only provide economic production.

6. Economy

The number of cards a player draws in Draw Phase is mainly based on two things: **Industry** and **Trade**.

6.1. Industry

Great Power gains Industry Value only from European regions (core industrial regions or provinces) under their ownership. Whether it has a trade route to the capital or other core regions does not affect Industry Value; even if there is a revolt, or the Industrial Region is controlled by the enemy, the total Industry Value will not be reduced.

During the game, make sure that the number of each Great Power's "Industry/Conscript"

markers is the same as the total Industry Cap of their owned regions.
Once into the game, there are only three possibilities for each unit of Industry:

a) In “Industry Value” area on Economy Board;
b) Converted as a conscript, on Main Map or Recovery Area;
c) In “Warships in Reserve” area on Economy Board, as maintenance cost of a battleship.

Great Powers may mobilize 1 unit of Conscript from each unit of their Core Industry. While this can improve their odds in every battle, it may reduce future card draw income. Note the following restriction:

- An industrial region comes under enemy control.

Regions satisfying either condition above cannot contribute to mobilization. The specific constraint is that you must hold markers in “Industry Value” area on your Economic Board equal to the total Industry Cap of these regions.

6.2. Trade

Great Power gains Trade Value only from their non-European regions (colonies) under their ownership and control. Trade Value is always independent of core-region status. However, each region’s Trade Value must travel along a complete trade route to the power’s core region before the player gains it.
Trade Route: The shortest path from a Trade Region to one of the country’s core regions. “Shortest Path” must travel along regions or sea zones marked on Main Map with higher priority, then off-map regions or off-map sea zones.
Example: Algeria provides 2 Trade Value, from West Mediterranean to Marseille’s port. France, who owns and controls Algeria, gains 2 Trade Value from there.

If the Trade Route of a region passes through off-map regions (between Ural and Manchuria) or off-map sea zones (between Atlantic Ocean and Cape of Good Hope), then the Trade Value of this region receives a -2 modifier when Great Power collects it.

- For example, Suez Canal is not open. India has 4 Trade Value. The shortest route to the port in British core regions is the Arabian Sea → Cape Route (passes through 2 off-map Sea Zones) → Atlantic Ocean. Britain gets only 2 Trade Value from India.
- If Suez Canal is open to Britain. India has 4 Trade Value. The shortest route to the port in British core regions is the Arabian Sea → Red Sea → East Mediterranean → West Mediterranean → Atlantic Ocean. Britain collects all 4 Trade Value.
- If there is no effective Trade Route from India to British core regions (e.g. the sea control is in their enemy’s hand), Britain gains 0 Trade Value from India.

When the Trade Toute passes through consecutively a sea zone and a region, make sure that the region connected the sea zone has a port.

After *Steamships*, the modifier to the Trade Value passing through off-map sea zones is -1 instead.

After *Open Door Policy*, China becomes a special trade region. China cannot be the colony

of any Great Power, but provides Trade Value to all Great Powers. It is necessary to check the Trade Route from China when counting Trade Value from China.

7. Cards

The Action Phase is mainly driven by cards. There are three categories: Hand Cards, Situation Cards and Mission Cards. These two types must be kept separate.

7.1. Hand Cards

In Draw Phase, each player determines how many cards to draw from the main deck according to their Industry Value and Trade Value, to form their hand. Each player's hand is private and may not be given to other players (except as allowed by specific Events or diplomacy).
Players mainly play hand cards during Action Phase. Played hand cards go to the discard pile (except their own Power Card) or are removed from the game if required by the text on cards. All played hand cards and the discard pile are always visible to all players.
At the start of each Draw Phase, take the unused main deck from last round, the discard pile, and any new hand cards entering this round, stack them together, shuffle to form a new main deck, then players draw their cards.
In your action turn, you may:

- Play the hand card as Event; or
- Spend the Ops on the card.

In Diplomacy Phase, players can also spend the Ops as the expenditure for diplomacy, to initiate a contest or intervene in a contest/war.

Before *War Fervor*, each player must end the round with only one hand card (excluding Power Cards). If, during a player's action turn, their hand exceeds the retention limit or their power card has not been played yet, they must play a hand card during that action turn.
There are two special types of hand cards:

- **Response Cards**: These may be played as Event during any other player's turn. Playing a Response Card temporarily interrupts another player's event or action (but does not cancel it), and the Response Card's event resolves first. If not used as a response, it may be played on your own turn as an Event or for Ops.
- **Power Cards**: Each player has a unique Power Card. It may be played as an Event or for Ops, but it cannot be drawn or discarded. Power Cards should be kept separate from other hand cards. After its usage each round, turn it sideways to show it has been spent for the round. Power Cards do not count against the hand limit, and they are reset to be usable at Draw Phase each round, no matter whether they were used in the last round.

On the card top, there is year, indicating in which scenario(s) to add in the card; after the year might be "aside", indicating that this card should be set aside from the deck.

7.2. Situation Cards

Situation Cards are public cards that only trigger as Events, and they affect the whole game. Situation Cards are played only in Situation Phase, so by default the term "deck" refers to the main deck. In Situation Phase, players confirm which new Situation Cards enter this round, then shuffle them together with any unused Situation Cards to form the situation deck. Reveal one card and resolve its event. Put played Situation Cards into "Situation Card in effect"; some situation cards will be in long-lasting effect, while some other take effects temporarily. A resolved Situation Card will not return to the Situation Deck.

Special Rule: *Eastern Question* and *Balkan Crisis* take temporarily effects, but they may re-enter the Situation Deck.

Some Situation Cards trigger in fixed rounds (therefore, other Situation Cards will not trigger this round):

a) **Round 1:** *Springtime of the Peoples*
b) **Round 5:** *Steamship*
c) **Round 9:** *War Fervor*

Some other Situation Cards join the deck or take effects once certain requirements are met:

- *Open-Door Policy*: Join the deck after *Opium War* is removed
- *Russo-Japanese War*, *Boxer Rebellion*: Join the deck after *Open-Door Policy*
- *Berlin Conference*: Check at Situation Phase, played if African Colonial Disputes Progress reaches 10

On the card top, there is year, indicating in which scenario(s) to add in the card; after the year might be "aside", indicating that this card should be set aside from the deck.

7.3. Mission Cards

Mission Cards set clear goals for players.

Each Mission Card is tied with certain Great Power. During the game, place the mission cards near players according to the Great Power they choose, with the card back face up (players can scrutinize their own mission card or even other players' mission cards, as this is no secret at all!).

When the condition is met, activate the mission card and flipped it to its front. Next, players can follow the instructions on cards to obtain extra bonus VPs or acquire long-term benefits. Some mission cards will be removed from the game after the condition is met, and then players cannot take actions or collect benefits guided by those cards.

8. Glossary

This section explains terms in the rulebook and on cards, and describes how relevant procedures are resolved.

8.1. General Glossary

Own: The de jure ownership of a region, which affects Victory Points.
Control: The temporary de facto occupation of a region, which will be removed after the war.
Annex: Equivalent to "own and control," used to describe a region being taken both legally and practically. If the annexed region was previously a war goal, the war must cancel immediately, and all the armies in neutral territories should be relocated.
Relocate: When a card effect or armistice changes regional control, regardless of any effective routes, units in neutral territory must be moved to the nearest region controlled by their friendly powers (according to the number of blocks in between – regions or sea zones).
Deploy: Place the unit(s) at a region or sea zone without costs, different from the action "Mobilize". Units may not be deployed in their enemy's-controlled region or a region with the enemy troops; it is not allowed to deploy Neutral Units in a region where there is unit from a power other than the local power.
Add a war goal: Place the "War Goal" marker on the target region, and the war immediately starts.
At war: In a war against Great Power, Major Power, or Minor Power. When there is an ongoing war, there must be a "War Goal" marker on Main Map or Diplomacy Chart. Conflict with Insignificant Power or Other Power is never seen as a war.
At peace: Not at war against Great Power, Major Power, or Minor Power.
Withdraw from the war: Remove the power's "War Goal" and "For/Against" markers, and also remove "War Goal" marker targeted on the power. If a "War Goal" is removed, then its attached "For/Against" markers from other Great Powers should be removed, which means that the war ends.
Destroy/Eliminate: Put conscripts into Recovery Area, and remove other types of armies from Main Map; Place battleships back to "Warships in Reserve" to trade for an Industry going to Recovery Area, and place frigates back to "Warships in Reserve" directly.
Allocate/Increase/Add influences: Directly put "Influence" markers on the region (still cannot exceed the local Industry Cap), different from the action "Apply/Reduce Influence".
Undergo a revolt: Put "Revolt" marker on the region.
Is independent/Independent country: The country does not own any region.
Become independent: The country had not owned any region, but now they are liberated and they annex their core region.
Return: The country is independent but does not own all its core regions. Now they annex this core region.
Connect: Two regions are connected via a solid or dash line; Two sea zones are connected, despite there might be a strait or canal; A region with a port is connected to its adjacent sea zone.
+1 Industry Cap: Place "+1 Industry Cap" on the region, then join an "Industry/Conscript" marker into the game and place it on Economy Board of the region's owner (Put it on Main Map instead if the owner is Major Power).
+1 Trade: If the region belongs to an independent Insignificant Power, place "+1 Trade" on Main Map; if the region is a colony, side this marker with Regional VP marker (convenient for calculating total Trade Value).

Homogenous core region/X-only core region: A region with only one ethnicity, different from dual-core region.
Change the capital: Put "New Capital" on certain region, while the old capital becomes normal Industrial Region.
Trade value from China: The Trade Value China produces for the Great Power. Move counter to mark this value.
Guarantee independence: Only triggered by *Court the Ottomans* and *Protect Romania*. When the Major Power is targeted by a contest, the one who guarantee their independence must join their side without cost of Ops (still need available "For/Against" marker). In this circumstance, Great Power can control the Major Power's armies (these units are seen as their own armies), until the withdrawal of the Major Power from the war.
Mobilization Penalty: Takes place when enemy controls your industrial region. Place the enemy's "Control" on "Industry markers" in Economy Board, to record how many Industry to reserve when mobilizing or building a battleship. The penalties from different regions may stack.

8.2. Diplomatic Terms

Cede a territory: Transfer ownership of your region (not illegal demands) to one enemy.
Return a territory: Return your province to a country that has a core there.
Recognize independence: Make your province independent from your country.
Reparation: Let an enemy player draw a card from your hand.
Demilitarization: Dismantle your fort.
Transfer a warship: Eliminate your battleship/frigate, and your enemy deploys a warship of the same kind.
Humiliate: Let an enemy player be rewarded with 1 War Winner VP
Recognize German Leadership: Give your "German Leadership" to your enemy.

Illegal Demand: a ceded region from a Great Power cannot be their homogenous core region. Whenever during a contest, armistice or surrender, illegal demands cannot be proposed.
Note:

a) Although German is the primary ethnicity of both Prussia and Austria, these two powers do not share homogenous core; however, they share dual-core, and they may demand over those regions, including Kiel, Metz, and Trentino.
b) At the start of scenario 1848, Austria owns Italian core regions Milan and Venice. If later, the region(s) is returned to Sardinia/Italy, Austria/AH may not claim the region(s).

8.3. Pronouns

a) **Friendly:** The active power, or the power(s) with their side within an ongoing contest or war.
b) **Ally:** A power who has an alliance with the active power. An Ally is not obligated to participate in the active power's ongoing wars.
c) **Enemy:** A power at war against the active power.

d) **Neutral:** A power not involved in the active power's war.

9. Game Flow

The game lasts 12 rounds, covering 1848–1920. Each round represents 6 years and is divided into six phases. In the final phase (the End Phase), check for winner(s). If no one wins, proceed to the next round.

There are two scenarios:

- Scenario 1848 – starts from Round 1
- Scenario 1872 – starts from Round 5

Below is a brief outline of each phase; each phase is resolved in order through its listed steps:

a. Draw Phase

i. Add new cards to the main deck, then shuffle
ii. Calculate the economy, then draw cards

b. Situation Phase

i. Add new cards to the situation deck, then shuffle
ii. Reveal 1 situation card and resolve its event
iii. Accumulate African Colonial Dispute Progress (only before *Berlin Conference* take effect)

c. Recovery Phase

i. Navy return to port
ii. Demobilize
iii. Economy recovery

d. Diplomacy Phase

i. Armistice
ii. Negotiate
iii. Initiate contest
iv. Intervene
v. Submit
vi. Escalation of Conflict
vii. Remove truce

e. Action Phase

i. France draws an agenda
ii. In turn order, each player plays hand cards as **Events** or for **Ops**
iii. Check whether fulfilled the agenda in *Parlement Français*
iv. Resolve *Boers Wars, Russo-Japanese War, American Civil War, and Indian Rebellion*

f. End Phase

i. Resolve victory of Revolt
ii. Resolve Great Powers' Influences
iii. Unconditional surrender
iv. Conditional surrender
v. Check for *Two-Power Standard* (since Round 5)
vi. Check for winner(s); if someone wins, the game ends, otherwise the next round begins.

Later sections will detail each phase.

10. Draw Phase

The number of hand cards each player draws depends on their Industry and Trade.

Industry Value can only be gained from European region that you own.
Note: Whether the region is controlled or in revolt does not affect the industry your gain; whether the region has a trade route to your capital or other core regions does not affect Industry Value.
Special rule: before completing *Emancipation Reform*, Russia may obtain fewer cards via its Industry.

Trade Value can only be gained from non-European regions you own and control (except Chinese regions). You must check whether the region is under your control or whether it is connected by a trade route to one of your controlled European core regions.
Exception: Germany may collect Trade Value from regions along Baghdad Railway.
A Trade Route exists if, from a Trade-Value region you own and control to any of your core regions you own and control, you can trace a path through connected regions and sea zones. Every region/sea zone on that path must satisfy:
a. The region is controlled by you.
b. The sea zone's Control is not held by your enemy.
Each region can have only one trade route, and its Trade Value can only be counted once. Trade Route travels along in-map regions and in-map sea zones with higher priority.

- If a Trade Route of a region passes through any off-map regions or off-map sea zones, then the Trade Value of this region is panelized with a -2 modifier.
- After *Steamship*, a Trade Route of a region passing through off-map sea zones is panelized with a -1 modifier instead.
- If there is no valid Trade Route from the starting region to your core region, then the region provides no Trade Value.

After calculating your total Trade Value, move the counter along the "Trade Value" on Economy Board track to mark the value.

A region provides either Industry Value or Trade Value (never both).

Your Economy Board indicates the number of cards you draw:

- Industry Draw: Place all Industry markers left to right in order. Take the nearest text "Draw X" to the right of your rightmost Industry marker.
- Trade Draw: Move your Trade counter along the track. Take the nearest text "Draw X" to the right of your Trade counter,

The total number of cards you draw equals the sum of the card income from Industry and Trade.

11. Situation Phase

The situation deck and the main deck must be kept separate. Before the game starts, take out the situation cards which will take effect under certain conditions, then shuffle the rest of the cards and make it a deck.

11.1. Draw a situation card

A designated player or the referee draws one card from the shuffled situation deck and resolves its event. A situation card might take effects all the time, while some other's effects are temporary. Situation cards will not re-enter the situation deck, unless it is repeatable.
Situation Cards affect the entire game and all players.

11.2. African Colonial Disputes and Berlin Conference

If *Berlin Conference* has not been activated yet, then accumulate the African Colonial Disputes Progress:

- At this moment, for each African Insignificant Power with its influences from at least two Great Power, progress +1.

If the progress reaches 10, then activate *Berlin Conference*: in the rest of the game, the action "Claim Sovereignty" is available for Great Powers.
Note: This progress will not go backwards; an Insignificant Power might push the counter forward for multiple times in different rounds.

12. Recovery Phase

12.1. Navy return to port

Players must move all their warships in Sea Zone to their nearest port controlled by their friendly powers without enemy troops on it. If there are multiple ports like that, players may decide which port to enter; if there is no such port (e.g. all ports are controlled by enemy, or the strait/canal in the only effective route is controlled by enemy), the warships will be destroyed.
As all warships leave their sea zones, Sea Control should be removed.
Warships can cross off-map sea zones.

12.2. Demobilize

Players may convert any number of their mobilized troops to Industry and put them back on

Economy Board.
When doing so, make sure that for each player, their total units of "Conscripts" + "Industry" on Economy Board must not exceed the total Industry Cap of their owned industrial regions. This might happen when the ownership of an Italian region is transferred.
If, due to a change of ownership, your total units of "Conscripts" + "Industry" exceeds the cap, you should place the excess markers into the recovery area, to be returned to correct position in the next stage.

12.3. Economy recovery

According to the ownership of regions, return the markers in Recovery Area to either main map or Economy Board. When returning them, besides the rule in 12.2., follow these principles below:

a) Great Powers' Industry must return to the Economy Board they belong to, until their "Conscripts" + "Industry" = Industry Cap.
b) Major Powers and Minor Powers' "Conscripts" are put onto their core regions, if they are independent; Industry of annexed regions return to Great Power's Economy Board. If these independent countries' regions are controlled by their enemy, then leave their conscripts in Recovery Area, of which the number is equal to the local Industry Cap.

13. Diplomacy Phase

The Diplomacy Phase provides a platform for players to deal with others and is also the key phase for changing the diplomatic circumstances. Normally, wars begin during the Diplomacy Phase.

13.1. Armistice

Players may reach an armistice (also called "white peace").
After obtaining consent from all enemy Great Powers, the Great Power who asks for an armistice must immediately fulfill all agreed terms and withdraw from the war. Then, put the "Truce" marker on Diplomacy Chart for the Great Powers that just end their rivalry.
These terms may include one or more of the following:

- **Cede a territory**
- **Return a territory**
- **Recognize independence**
- **Reparation**
- **Demilitarization**
- **Transfer a warship**
- **Humiliate**

When there is a change in the ownership, conduct the following procedures:

1. Replace the old "Own" marker with the one from the new owner on the region; If they already have the "Control" marker there, just flip it to the other

side.

2. Move the regional VP marker of the region to the new owner's VP Board.
3. If an Industrial Region changes ownership, check the local Industry Cap. Move the "Industry" markers, with an equal number to local Industry Cap, to the new owner's Economy Board.

If, in this stage, a power withdraws from the war, then remove their "War Goal" or "For/Against" for this war, and remove "War Goal" targeted on them. Clear all their "Control" on neutral regions, and clear all "Control" on their territories.

Note: An armistice does not mean the war ends; it only means that a Great Power withdraw from the war. If, after a player withdraws, "War Goal" remains, then the war will go on, until "War Goal" is removed (i.e. powers from either side all withdraw from the war).
Major Powers and Minor Powers will never reach an armistice with Great Powers, unless their independence are guaranteed. Therefore, Great Power may only surrender or force those powers to surrender to make them withdraw.

Unilateral Armistice:
If you are called into the war due to the alliance, you may not withdraw from a war via an armistice; only the targeted power as War Goal has the right to end the war via armistice.
If you are called into the war due to the guarantee of independence, you may reach an armistice with enemy in the name of this Major Power. Likewise, you may not withdraw from the war alone.

13.2. Negotiation

Players may conduct various diplomatic activities, including but not limited to:

a) Form alliance(s)
b) Cancel alliance(s)
c) Cancel guarantee of independence
d) Gift a hand card (only by having the recipient draw it; each power may give at most one card)
e) Transfer a region to another player (at most one region; it cannot be your homogenous core region)

Note that all alliances are defensive. Allies keep obligations as follows:

- When a country is the contest/war goal, their allied power (or the power who guarantee their independence) join that country's side automatically, without adding their "For/Against" marker. If you ally a power who has been the war goal, you are considered in this war as defender.
- Power cannot join the other side of their ally when intervening in a contest/war.

You are not obliged to join your ally's side when your ally initiates a contest or voluntarily chooses a side in a contest. You are considered your ally's friendly power only if you intervene in this offensive contest/war.

When conducting option (a), (d) or (e), it requires both parties' permission, and these parties cannot be enemy to each other;
There is no such restriction for option (b) and (c), but this requires that you and your ally/protected power are not friendly in the same war.
Before allying your ally's enemy, you must cancel the alliance between you and your former ally.

Players may also reach agreements or make promises about future matters, but none of these are binding.
Special Rule: In the last round of the game, players may not form or cancel alliances. If the alliance is broken in other stages (e.g. your ally invades another ally of you, so you must break your alliance with the invader), then this rule will not apply.

13.3. Initiate Contest

Great Powers may spend Ops to initiate contest(s).
Each Great Power has one "Contest Goal/War Goal" marker, which means that they may initiate up to one contest in this stage. The Great Power may take it back only when this contest/war ends.

Cards used for Ops cannot be kept for the next phase/stage; even there is unused Ops on that card, the card must be discarded.
Target a Great Power, Major Power or Minor Power. Each target costs 2 points and immediately becomes a contest. The target cannot be allied with you, or already in the same war as you (whether as an ally or an enemy).
Cost for a contest:

- 2 Ops for initiating a contest against a Great Power.
- 1 Op for initiating a contest against a Major Power or a Minor Power.

The target of contest cannot be an Insignificant Power. It is not necessary to do so.
There are limitations for initiating a contest:

- The target country must not be your ally.
- The target country's independence must not be guaranteed by you.
- The target country must not be in your war (whether as friendly power or enemy).
- The target country must not have a truce with you.

After initiating a contest, choose your target country and put your "Contest Goal" marker to the corresponding area. According to the strategic outcome you want to achieve, place the marker onto the:

- Region (except Capital). Cede a territory, return a territory or recognize independence. Put the marker onto the targeted region.
- Diplomacy Chart. Recognize German Leadership (by Prussia or Austria/AH only, before Germany is formed). Put the marker at the specific area on Diplomacy Chart.

After the breakout of the war, once the war goal is satisfied, you can force your enemy to surrender in End Phase and fulfil your demand.

Note: If the "Contests Goal" is on a region, it cannot be illegal.

If a region has already been targeted, another contest against the region's owner may target that region too.
Example: If Austria-Hungary has targeted Bosnia from the Ottoman Empire, the Russian Empire may initiate a contest against the Ottoman Empire and target Bosnia, too.
If the ownership of a region changes (e.g., the Ottoman Empire cedes Bosnia to Austria-Hungary), then all "War Goal" on that region should be removed (e.g., Russia's war goal on Bosnia is removed).

13.4. Intervene

Players may intervene in ongoing contests or wars.
Each Great Power has one "For/Against" marker, which means that they may intervene in up to one contests/war at the same time. Great Power may take it back only when they withdraw from the contest/war.

Players may offer ownership of a region (not illegal) or a hand card (by having the recipient draw it) in exchange for support. If the recipient accepts, they must play the "For/Against" marker to intervene and join the proposer's side.
Or, players may announce to join each other's side in two different contests at the same time. Players may choose either side, or they may remain neutral to wait for offers. However, once choosing either side, player cannot switch to the other side or return to neutral. When choosing a side, put your "For/Against" marker next to the "Contest/War Goal" marker which denotes the ongoing conflict.

- For: Join the side of the contest/war' initiator
- Against: Join the side of the contest/war's defender

There are restrictions when intervene in a contest/war:

- You cannot be FOR the power who is your enemy in another contest/war.
- After your enemy in another contest/war intervenes in a contest/war, you cannot join the same side as your enemy in this contest/war.
- You cannot join the opposite to the one who has truce with you
- You cannot be AGAINST the power who is your friend in another contest/war.
- After your friend in another contest/war intervenes in a contest/war, you cannot join the opposite side to your friend in this contest.
- You cannot be AGAINST your ally, and you cannot join the opposite to your ally in a contest.

If a power is allied with you or their independence is guaranteed by you, you automatically join their side as friendly power when they are the contest/war goal. On this occasion, you do not need to use the "For/Against" marker for intervention.
Special Rule: If the power you must defend is the contest target by your ally, you should always join the defender, because these alliances are always defensive. If you happen to be the enemy of your allied power (no matter whether the war breaks out), the alliance between

you and your enemy ally must immediately breaks.

13.5. Submit

During this stage, a player may withdraw from a contest in case it escalates into a war in following ways.

- The player who is targeted in a contest may have the goal fulfilled and withdraw from the contest. Then the "Contest Goal" is removed.
- The player who initiated a contest may give up their goal and withdraw from the contest. Then the "Contest Goal" is removed.

After *War Fervor*, Great Powers cannot submit.

13.6. Escalation of Conflict

Check for contests and determine their outcome:

I. If one side has **two or more Great Powers** and the other side has **no Great Powers**, the Great Power–supported side automatically fulfils their war goal against the other side. Then remove the "Contest Goal".

   Exceptional Rule:

   If the consequence cannot be decided, due to multiple pairs of Great Powers targeting the same region (e.g. Britain supports France's annexation of Brussels, while AH supports Italy's annexation of Brussels too), then these contests will escalate into war still.

- In any other case (e.g., two Great Powers vs. one Great Power), flip the "Contest Goal" to the other side "War Goal". This means that the contest has not been solved peacefully but escalates into a war.

In a war, all countries on the same side are seen friendly, and they share deployment access, military access and joint defense.

13.7. Remove Truce

Remove all "Truce" markers from Diplomacy Chart.

14. Action Phase

In turn order, each player either plays a card as an **Event**, spends its **Ops**, or **passes** their turn. When meeting both conditions below, a player may pass the turn instead of playing a card:

- The Power card has been used.
- Except for Power card, the player only has up to 1 hand card.
  After *War Fervor*, change this to "Except for Power card, the player only has up to 2 hand cards".

Once passing their turn, the player cannot play cards but pass their turns in the rest of this Action Phase (denote this by giving him a "Passed" marker), **unless** they obtain a new card (e.g. Britain plays *Balance of Power* to send them a card).

After the last player in action turn finishes their action, it returns to the first player, and this cycle repeats until six consecutive players all pass their turn.

When spending Ops, it is recommended to spend all of them, because they do not carry over to your next turn.
Players may spend Ops to perform the following actions. These actions can be repeated or combined:

	Britain	France	Prussia/ Germany	Sardinia/ Italy	Russia	Austria/ AH
Mobilize	1	1	1	1	1	1
Unit Move	1	1	1	1	1	1
Control Region	1	1	1	1	1	1
Naval Move	1	1	1	1	1	1
Naval Attack	1	1	1	1	1	1
Build Warship	4/2	4/2	4/2	4/2	4/2	4/2
Technology	1	1	1	1	1	1
Apply/Reduce Influence	2	2	2	2	2	2
Claim Sovereignty (Africa)	n	n	n	n	n	n
Claim Sovereignty (Asia)	n, by India/Ural's owner					
Suppress	n	n	n	n	n	n
Defend India	2, by India's owner					
Support Asian Powers	2, by Ural's owner					
Build Suez Canal	1	1	-	-	-	-
Emancipation Reform	-	-	-	-	1	-
Baghdad Railway	-	-	2/1	-	-	-

n denotes that the cost is changeable according to the scenario.

Mobilize

Players may spend 1 Op mobilizing 1 unit of Industry to 1 Conscript; after *War Fervor*, each player may spend 1 Op mobilizing up to 2 units of Industry to 2 Conscripts. By doing so, take an "Industry" marker from your Economy Board and flip it to the "Conscript" side.
Then, you may deploy your newly mobilized unit to the region you control – it can be your core region or your non-core region.
If it is your core region, then no restrictions are imposed.
If it is your non-core region, then must be a valid route from your core region to your non-core destination:

- The starting region, the ending region, and all traversed regions must be controlled by your friendly power (Exception: the off-map regions between Ural and Manchuria do not need to be controlled)

- Cannot pass through Difficult Path.
- Any traversed sea zone must contain no enemy fleets (it is not sufficient to merely have sea control).

The route may cross over off-map regions or off-map sea zones.

Mobilization limit:

- You may not mobilize your non-core Industry to Conscript.
- If your Industrial Region is controlled by your enemy, you must have certain units of Industry reserved on your Economy Board, of which the number is equal to the total Industry Cap in these enemy-controlled regions.

Instantly mark the maximum number of units you may mobilize with your Enemy's "Control" markers. You may check in detail "Control a Region" in this section and section 15.2.

Army Movement & Land Battle

A player may spend 1 Op moving their armies (up to 5 units) from one region to an adjacent region connected by a solid line, or 2 Ops by a dash line (Difficult Path). The destination must satisfy one of the following:

- Controlled by your friendly powers; or
- Controlled by your enemy; or
- Owned by independent Insignificant Power (regardless of control).

Exceptional Rule: Army may cross off-map regions via continuous movement, but they may not stay there.

When the player moves units into a region where there are their enemy's troops (including their controlled fortress) or "Neutral Units", the movement must pause. This counts as an attack on that region. All enemy units there (including Neutral Units from Insignificant Powers and Other Powers) are the defender.

Units from multiple regions can move simultaneously, which means a land attack may come from different directions. Resolve the battle after all these units move into the destination. **For example**, Germany spends 1 Op moving 2 units from Königsberg to Warsaw and 1 Op moving 3 armies from Silesia to Warsaw, a total of 5 armies to attack Warsaw controlled by Russia.

There is an upper limit for army units engaged in a battle: there should be at most 5 units on either side as attacker or defender. The rest of the units do not engage in the battle, but they may retreat together with battling units. Either side decides which units to engage in the battle.

The attacker and defender roll their dice respectively. The number of dice to roll depends on the number of units they have engaged in this battle: Add a die for each conscript or neutral unit; add a half die for each reservist (round down).

Before resolving the battle, apply Dice Count Modifiers, which may come from:

- Response Card.
- Attacking a fortress region. The attacker receives a -1 Dice Count Modifier, and the defender receives a +1 Dice Count Modifier. Note that, even if no units are defending, the fortress still gives a die.

Note: only when the defender is controlling the region, may they get the modifier from fortress during battle.

- All units are crossing a difficult path before engaging in this battle. The attacker receives a -1 Dice Count Modifier.
- Only reservists engage in this battle (either as the attacker or the defender). This side receives a -1 Dice Count Modifier.

After making clear the number of dice to roll, roll these dice simultaneously. Each roll of "5" or "6" scores one hit. After seeing the dice roll results, players may play a response card for its Dice Roll Modifier; Prussia/Germany's power card *General Staff* can only be played before checking the results. A Dice Roll Modifier gives a +1 result modifier to all your dice in the battle.

After confirming the number of hits for both sides, follow these steps:

a) Combat Victory & Defeat

The side which hit more wins the battle. If both sides hit the same, the defender wins.

b) Battle Loss Allocation

Each hit eliminates an enemy unit. When the defender bears their loss:

- If only one Great Power participates in the defense, the Great Power freely chooses which units to eliminate.
- If the defending units come from multiple countries, the casualties are split evenly among these countries; if indivisible, the remainder is assigned first to Great Power's units, and then to non-Great-Power units; if casualties cannot split evenly among Great Powers, they negotiate the allocation.

Place all eliminated conscripts to Recovery Area; "Neutral Units" and reservists are removed from Main Map. Surviving units wait for retreat resolution

c) Retreat:

The side who loses the battle must retreat their troops if they have any units left.

Non-Great-Power's troops never retreat. Instead, their troops are eliminated directly (unless their independence is guaranteed and their troops are controlled by Great Powers).

The attacker Great Power must retreat their units back to where they were before the battle. When multiple Great Powers defend together, each decides their retreat movement in the order of their action turn.

Retreat Movement Rule for the defender:

- Retreating units may move to adjacent friendly-controlled regions. They may not enter neutral regions (including allies not in their war) or enemy-controlled regions. They may not enter where the attacker was before the battle, and they may not enter the region where there is enemy unit(s).

  Units may be split and they are allowed to retreat to different valid adjacent regions.
- A legal destination is required when retreating. It is prohibited to retreat into an off-map region (e.g. between Ural and Manchuria). Units without legal retreat paths are eliminated.
- If a port region loses control after combat, the warships there must retreat to the nearest friendly-controlled port (without enemy units). The route cannot pass

through straits or canals controlled by enemy. Warships without legal retreat paths are eliminated.

Special Rule – attack a third-party region: You can move your armies and attack a region owned neither by friendly nor enemy (e.g. owned by a neutral third party at war with your enemy) but controlled by your enemy. However, even if you win the battle, your armies must retreat to where they are before the battle.

Army movement and attacks can be performed multiple times in a single action turn, but a player may not move to a region again in the same turn if an earlier attack (including amphibious assault) in that region failed. The player may move there again only in a later action turn.

Army Movement across Sea & Amphibious Assault

A player may spend n Ops moving their armies (up to 5 units) from a port region across several sea zones to an enemy-controlled port region. n equals the sea zones and regions traversed, so n is at least 2. The destination must satisfy one of the following:

- Controlled by your friendly powers; or
- Controlled by your enemy; or
- Owned by independent Insignificant Power (regardless of control).

Before moving across the sea, make sure:

- The sea zone(s) that you cross must be free of enemy fleets (merely under your sea control is not sufficient).
- All straits or canals you cross must not be controlled by the enemy.
- In the sea zone(s) you cross, your friendly powers' Power Projection must be greater than the enemy's.

  Power Projection: The total number of a power's warships in the sea zone and the sea zone's connected ports is the power's Power Projection in the sea zone. During the war, the side with a higher Power Projection in a sea zone may move their units across the sea zone.

Exceptional Rule: Army may cross off-map sea zones via continuous movement, but they may not stay there.

If there are enemy's troops (including a fortress) or "Neutral Units" in the port region as the destination, the movement must pause. This counts as an amphibious assault on that region (An amphibious assault is a special form of land attack). All enemy units there (including Neutral Units from Insignificant Powers and Other Powers) are the defender.
The procedure to resolve the amphibious assault is the same with the land battle. However, before the resolution, apply the modifier below:

- The attacker of an amphibious assault receives a -1 Dice Count Modifier.

The modifier of amphibious assault may stack with other modifiers.

Different from a usual land battle, if the assault fails, the rest of attacking troops should be

placed back to the port region before the assault.

Army movement across sea and amphibious assaults can be performed multiple times in a single action turn, but a player may not move to a region again in the same turn if an earlier amphibious assault (including any other form of land attack) in that region failed. The player may move there again only in a later action turn.

Control a Region

A player may spend 1 Op to control a region. To do so, they must have their unit(s) there and have a **Supply Route**.
The region must satisfy either of the following:

- Owned and controlled by your enemy; or
- Owned by your friendly power but controlled by your enemy.

Supply Route: Works the same as Trade Route. A Supply Route exists if, from the region you are about to control to any of your core regions you own and control, you can trace a path through connected regions and sea zones. Every region/sea zone on that path must satisfy:
a. The region is controlled by your friendly power (not merely your own – which is the only difference from Trade Route).
b. The sea zone's Control is not held by your enemy.

When you control your enemy's region, put your "Control" marker on the region. Moreover, if you happen to control a Great Power's Industrial Region, you should also:

a) Place your another "Control" marker on the power's Economy Board, to record how many "Industry" markers they must preserve. Put the marker on the nth industry marker from left to right on their Economy Board, where n is the Industry Cap of the region.
   The negative effects of "Control" markers on different regions on mobilizing ability may stack.

In contrast, you may spend 1 Op to restore control of any friendly power on the region. When doing so, just remove your enemy's "Control".

Players may not control an Insignificant Power. Only after an Insignificant Power is annexed (whichever by claiming sovereignty or applying influence), players can own and control the region.

Naval Movement

A player may spend 1 Op to move all their warships up to one zone. During the movement, the warships may move to the adjacent port region or sea zone. As the movement of warships is **simultaneous**, it is recommended that players decide which warships to move before making a continuous movement; after all these warships move by one zone, the player may spend 1 Op again conducting the next Naval Movement.
During naval movement, your warships cannot pass through straits or canals controlled by

your enemy.
When you move your warships into a port region, the region must be friendly controlled and there is no enemy unit on it.
Unlike army movement, warships may enter any sea zone, even the one that contains enemy fleets.

Warships cannot stay in off-map sea zones, but they can cross them.

Naval movement can be performed multiple times in a single action turn, but warships that retreated may not move again until the next action turn.

Naval Attack

Control of a sea zone is **neutral by default**. During the war, Great Powers can seize the sea control (Japan may also do this in *Russo-Japanese War*). Warring sides must use naval attacks to seize the sea control of a sea zone; the country that gains sea control can effectively cut enemy's trade routes.
Changes in sea control do not affect neutral Great Powers. Therefore, there might be sea controls from multiple Great Powers, who are not at war with each other.

A player may spend 1 Op to select their fleet in a sea zone with at least one battleship (the fleet may include friendly warships from other players, but it requires their permission) to launch a naval attack on enemy's fleet in that sea zone.
Note:

b) If the warships in the sea zone belong to enemy powers from multiple wars (you are fighting against these powers in different wars, but they may not be friendly to each other, and they may even be fighting each other), the attacker chooses one of the enemy fleets to attack.
c) If the attacker's warships belong to multiple Great Powers, the commander is the player who initiate the attack; If the defender's warships belong to multiple Great Powers, the commander is the player with the most ships (negotiate if there is a tie).

Before the battle, both sides must declare the number of ships participating in the sea battle, including battleships and frigates. Different from a land battle, a sea battle could last for several turns. Each turn of a sea battle proceeds as follows:
a) The attacker first declares whether to bombard or retreat.
b) The defender then declares whether to bombard or retreat.
c) Resolve the combat this turn according to their declarations by rolling dice.

- If both sides bombard, then resolve both bombardments simultaneously.
- If both sides retreat, resolve both retreats simultaneously.
- If one side bombards and the other side retreats, first resolve the bombardment then resolve the retreat.

d) Determine the winner of the sea battle:

- If both sides still have ships left, the battle continues – **go back to step (a)**.

- If one side has no ships left (whether destroyed or retreated), the other side with ships left wins the battle.
- If neither side has any ships left, the defender wins the battle.

e) Determine the change of sea control:

- If the attacker wins, they gain sea control of that sea zone, and the defender loses the sea control, regardless of whether the defender previously had control there.
- If the attacker loses, the sea control does not change.

f) Ship retreat:

Any ships that retreat from the sea battle must retreat to the nearest port region by friendly power (and without enemy units on it). Repair all battleships that successfully retreated.

When retreating, the warships may not pass through any strait or canal controlled by an enemy; Warships without legal retreat paths are eliminated.

The detailed resolution procedure for **bombardment** and **retreat** is as follows:

a) **Bombardment**: Roll dice. The number of dice to roll is relevant to the number of your battleships and their condition.

   Number of dice = 2 * battleships in perfect condition + 1 * battleships in damage condition. Each "5" or "6" scores a hit:

   Then resolve these hits one by one for the enemy side.

   1. If the number of frigates ⩾ the number of battleships, eliminate a frigate.
   2. If the number of frigates < the number of battleships, eliminate a damaged battleship, or damage a battleship in perfect condition (flip it over). Prioritize damaging battleships in perfect condition, until all battleships are damaged.

   Repeat this process for the number of hits.

- **Retreat**: Roll a die. The maximum number of ships that may retreat this time is the die result. The retreating side may choose freely which ships to withdraw from the sea battle.

  Damaged battleships that successfully retreated to ports should be flipped to their front side, meaning that they are repaired.

Special Rule: After winning a sea battle, if the sea zone still contains an enemy fleet from another war, the player must attack and defeat the fleet as well to comprehensively seize the sea control of that sea zone. In another word, winning this sea battle is just sufficient to remove one single opponent's sea control.

If the sea zone contains your fleet but no enemy fleet, you still need to spend 1 Op to claim sea control (your fleet must include at least one battleship). If you do, you automatically gain sea control.

In Action Phase, a Great Power loses their sea control probably because:

- They lost a sea battle.
- They do not have any battleship left in the sea zone due to a naval movement.

  Refer to section 12.1., that Great Power may lose their sea control when their navy return to port.

Build Warships

A player may build warships. There are two types of warships: battleships and frigates.
You may spend 4 Ops building a battleship. Take a battleship from "Warships in Reserve" on your Economy Board and deploy it in a port region you own and control, then move 1 unit of your core Industry to where the battleship left.
You may spend 2 Ops building a frigate. Take a frigate from "Warships in Reserve" on your Economy Board and deploy it in a port region you own and control.
Note: If you cannot mobilize more units when there is a "Mobilization Penalty", then you cannot build the battleship either.

Technology

A player may invest 1 Op into their technology.
For each Op spent, the command points are advanced by 1. When it reaches "Clear", clear it and advance the bonus points by 1. For each bonus point, the player gets 1 VP and adds 1 Industry Cap in a core industrial region they own and control, as well as 1 unit of Industry.
The Command Points required to advance the Bonus progress are different at its levels and in a growing state. To advance the Bonus Points from 0 to 1, it requires 6 Command Points; An additional Command Point is required for the next advancement, until the Bonus Points are 5 (which costs 10 Command Points). A player may collect the technology bonus up to 5 times.

Before finishing *Emancipation Reform*, Russia's action in technology is restricted. Russia may not invest their Ops to command points, unless they push the reform progress forward. For example, when the reform reaches 2, Russia may spend Ops into technology command, until the bonus hits 1; when the reforms reaches 4, Russia may continue it, until the bonus hits 2, and so on.

Apply/Reduce Influence

A player may spend 2 Ops taking this action in an independent Insignificant Power.
Next, roll dice to resolve this action. Before rolling dice, apply Dice Count Modifiers. Except for one basic die, for each of the following conditions met, you will receive a +1 Dice Count Modifier:

- You have at least 1 unit in this Insignificant Power's region.
- You have at least 1 unit in a region connected to the Insignificant Power with solid line.
- You own a region connected to the Insignificant Power with solid line.
- You have at least 1 warship in a sea zone connected to the Insignificant Power.

Before resolution, a Dice Roll Modifier might be given:

- *Establish Puppet Government* is played as Event.
- *Colonial Governorate* is played as Event.

The Dice Count Modifiers stack. **For example**, Morocco connects to both Eastern

Mediterranean Sea and West Mediterranean Sea. If Italy has one warship in each sea zone, Italy will roll 3 dice when taking this action.
A Dice Roll Modifier gives a +1 result modifier to all your dice in the action.

After rolling the dice, if at least one roll hits "5" or "6", you may choose to increase your Influence by 1 or reduce another Great Power's Influence by 1 in that Insignificant Power.
Special Rule: After activating *Local Autonomy*, Austria/AH may apply influence in an independent Minor Power, with the same procedures as the above. As units may not enter Minor Power's region, the first Dice Count Modifier is not available.

Influences allow a Great Power to annex the region.
The maximum influences that a region has from Great Powers is 3. When a region accumulates 3 influences, a Great Power cannot add more influences there before reducing other power's influences.
Influence does not apply to Great Power, Major Power or their colonies.

Claim Sovereignty (Only by India/Ural's owner or *Berlin Conference* is activated)

A player may spend n Ops annexing an independent Insignificant Power region, where n is the local Trade Value and it must be at least 1. To do so, they must have their unit(s) there.
Different from annexing a region via influence, claiming the sovereignty might ask you to defeat the local neutral units by force. After annexation, remove all the influences there.

Claiming Sovereignty may be conducted only in either condition below:

a) Claiming sovereignty over an Asian Insignificant Power: only by the owner of Ural or the owner of India.
b) Claiming sovereignty over an African Insignificant Power: only by Great Power, after *Berlin Conference* is activated.

Suppress Revolt

A player may spend n Ops suppressing a revolt in a region, where n is the local Industry Cap and it must be at least 1. To do so, they must have their unit(s) there. After suppression of a revolt: remove the "Revolt" marker from the region..
During the game, players may even move their units to enemy's region to stop the enemy suppressing a revolt. Meanwhile, even if a revolt is happening in a region you do not own, you may suppress it still.

Build Suez Canal (only by Britain & France)

When Britain or France collected 2 bonus points from their technology, they may start to contribute to Suez Canal construction.

If both Sinai and Egypt are owned by Ottoman, Britain or France may spend 1 Op in each their action turn pushing their Suez Canal Construction Progress by 1. When the total progress (sum of British and French progress) reaches 7, Suez Canal will be constructed. The power with the higher progress in the canal construction can grab the victory points.
Once Suez Canal is built, *Protectorate in Egypt* will be activated.

Emancipation Reform (only by Russia)

When one of the following conditions fulfills, *Emancipation Reform* is activated and then Russia starts the reform:

- Russia surrenders to any other Great Power
- Russia suffers an elimination of 3 army units in a single battle
- Russia loses control of a fort they own

Before completing the reform (even if *Emancipation Reform* has not yet been activated), Russia suffers penalty of hand card income and technology restriction.
When *Emancipation Reform* is activated, Russia may spend Ops advancing an equivalent amount of reform progress on their VP Board. For every 2 Ops spent, the upper limit of Russia's technology bonus points is raised by 1; When it reaches 10, the reform is completed and then Russia will no longer suffer both penalties.
If *Vladimir Ilyich Lenin* is played before reform starts or reform is done, then the progress automatically reaches 10, and then the reform is done.

Baghdad Railway (only by Germany)

After foundation of Germany, *Baghdad Railway* is activated and Germany starts building the railway.
You (Germany) may spend 1 Op advancing the railway marker by 1 space along a solid arrow, or you may spend 2 Ops to advance it by 1 space along a dash arrow. The location of the railway stage marker confirms the farthest node of the railway.
There are two stages for building the railway. You may start Stage 2 construction the next round after finishing Stage 1.

1) **Stage 1**: When "Baghdad Railway Stage 1" marker arrives in Budapest, choose the branch (choose which side to be up) and advance it. When the marker reaches Constantinople, leave the marker there. Germany gets 1 VP.
   Reward for finishing Stage 1: During the rest of the game, as long as Germany is not at war against Ottoman, Germany can have their army units across the regions controlled by Ottoman when mobilizing or land moving (but they cannot stay, unless Ottoman is friendly).
2) **Stage 2**: Choose the branch and advance "Baghdad Railway Stage 2" marker. When the marker reaches Basra, the railway is completed. Germany gets another 1 VP.

During the construction of the railway, for Germany:

- To advance the railway stage marker to the next node, the region must satisfy one of the following conditions:

a) Controlled by non-Great-Power; or
b) Controlled by you; or
c) Controlled by your ally.

- When the marker is in either branch, you can place it back to the starting point of the branches during your action turn (if you have not passed it), which means that you restart your construction from there. For example, put "Baghdad Railway Stage 1" marker from Cluj back to Budapest.
  You may flip the railway stage marker anytime to indicate which branch you choose to construct.

Even the railroad stage has not yet been completed, it may still provide benefits for Germany and even all Great Powers.
Baghdad Railway provides Germany with benefits below:

- Germany directly collects Trade Value from the railway's regions not controlled by Great Power, unless there is a node between this region and Berlin (both ends inclusive) is controlled by a Great Power not allied with Germany.
- If there is a Trade Route from Germany's colony to any railway node, Germany directly collects Trade Value from this colony, unless there is a node between this node and Berlin (both ends inclusive) is controlled by a Great Power not allied with Germany.

Moreover, Baghdad Railway provides all Great Powers with benefits below:

- During the rest of the game, all the dash lines along Baghdad Railway are seen as solid lines. The limitations imposed by these dash lines are ignored whatever action to take.

Defend India (only by India's owner)

Once per round, the owner of India may spend 2 Ops deploying 1 unit Reservist in India (they must control India when doing so).

Support Asian Powers (only by Ural's owner)

Once per round, the owner of Ural may spend 2 Ops deploying 1 Neutral Unit for an Asian Insignificant Power (max 4 for local Neutral Units).

15. End Phase

This is the final phase of the round.

15.1. Resolve Revolt in Success

All the ongoing revolts seized victory. Conduct the following process:

- Remove the "Revolt" marker on the province.
- If the country who has the core in that region is independent, then return the region;

if not, the region becomes independent.

- Turn over the "Province" marker to "Independent" and put it back on Main Map.
- Put back the "Industry" markers back to Main Map according to the local Industry Cap.

Special case: If multiple Great Powers incur revolts by a single ethnicity which does not have an independent country, then these regions merge into one country after their independence.

15.2. Resolve Influence from Great Powers

If, during this stage, a Great Power has accumulated 3 influences in an independent Insignificant Power/Minor Power, then the Great Power immediately annexes it and makes it a colony/province. Next, remove all influences there.

15.3. Unconditional Surrender

Check in this stage, if a country's (Great Power/Major Power/Minor Power) capital is controlled by the enemy, then they must surrender unconditionally.
Except for the war goal which must be realized, each enemy Great Power may ask for two extra demands that target this country, and the country must agree to realize all these demands. If multiple Great Powers ask for demands, resolve their demands in action turn.
Moreover, when a Great Power surrenders unconditionally, each enemy Great Power gains 1 War Winner VP.
Finally, put the "Truce" marker on Diplomacy Chart for the Great Powers that just end their rivalry.

These extra demands could be:

- Cede a territory
- Return a territory
- Recognize independence
- Reparation
- Demilitarization
- Transfer a warship
- Humiliate
- Recognize German Leadership

Of the options above, all can target a Great Power; only ceding a territory, returning a territory, recognizing independence, and Demilitarization can target a Major/Minor Power.

Additional Rules:

- **Overlapping demand**: The demand of a region may not be realized twice. However, "Reparation", "Reparation", "Transfer a warship" and "Humiliate" may be taken multiple times.
- **Ceding a capital**: Illegal demands cannot be realized, so Great Powers may not cede their capital; However, Major/Minor Power's capital could be ceded. If the power

owns more than one region, then once its capital is ceded, pick its region with the highest Industry Cap as its new capital; randomly roll a die if there is a tie.

When there are multiple wars await for resolution, follow the procedures below:

a) Resolve the wars between Great Powers and Major/Minor Powers, followed by the wars between Great Powers. The fewer Great Powers involved in a war, the higher priority the war is settled.
b) For a single war, except for the country as war target, first resolve the unconditional surrender of Minor Powers, then Major Powers, then Great Powers in action turn. Resolve the unconditional surrender of the targeted country at last.
c) Resolve all unconditional surrenders of a war, then resolve another war.

Special case: If both sides have at least one Great Power surrendering to the other side, then resolve these surrenders simultaneously. These surrendering Great Powers cannot propose any demands, despite that their enemy unconditionally surrender too. Meanwhile, the surrendering Great Powers cannot gain War Winner VP in this case.

After resolving a power's unconditional surrender, the power withdraws from the war.

Unilateral Surrender:
If you are called into the war due to the alliance/guarantee of independence, you will break this alliance/guarantee of independence immediately when you withdraw from the war due to an unconditional surrender.

15.4. Conditional Surrender

A player may give up their war goal in their war and surrender conditionally. In this case, the war goal which targets this player must be realized.
Sometimes a player may want to have peace with non-Great-Power, then they may surrender to the power. As a Major/Minor Power never put forward a war goal (except Ottomans), so this type of surrender is free of loss.

However, if a war goal has been achieved, then the targeted power must surrender conditionally, unless *War Fervor* is in effect.
For example, Prussia's war goal is Metz from France. Prussia has already controlled Metz, then France must surrender and let Prussia realize its demand. Consequently, Prussia may ask France to cede Metz and transfer its ownership to Prussia.
Moreover, when a Great Power surrenders conditionally, each enemy Great Power gains 1 War Winner VP.

According to the war goal, check whether the goal has been achieved:

a) **War goal on region**
War Goal is achieved when controlling enemy's targeted region. The contest/war initiator may force the enemy to realize one of the demands below about this region:
- Cede a territory

- Return a territory
- Recognize independence

b) War Goal of German Leadership

This war goal can only be initiated by either Prussia or Austria/AH against the other one.

War Goal is achieved when the contest/war initiator and their friendly power win more battles than the enemy during this war. The contest/war initiator may force the target country to realize the demand below:

- Recognize the German Leadership

Exceptional Rule: If the gap of the battles won reaches 3 during Action Phase, then the side with more winning battles automatically win this war. Remove "War Goal" from Diplomacy Chart, the war ends immediately and carry out the conditional surrender (regardless of whether the capital is controlled).

When there are multiple wars await for resolution, follow the procedures below:

a) Resolve the wars between Great Powers and Major/Minor Powers, followed by the wars between Great Powers. The fewer Great Powers involved in a war, the higher priority the war is settled.

b) Resolve all unconditional surrenders of a war, then resolve another war.

After resolving a power's conditional surrender, the power withdraws from the war.

Unilateral Surrender:

If you are called into the war due to the alliance/guarantee of independence, you will break this alliance/guarantee of independence immediately when you withdraw from the war due to a conditional surrender.

15.5. Check for Winners

- If any player reaches 30 VP, that player wins.
- If multiple players reach 30 VP, the highest score wins.
- If no one reaches 30, or multiple players are tied over 30, the game continues to the next round.
- In the final round:
  the highest score wins;
  if multiple players are tied, then the game ends with "Balanced Europe".
- Since Round 9, a "Second Victor" is available:
  if the victor is allied with any other Great Power, then the highest score among its allies becomes the "Second Victor";
  if there is a tie among the allies of the "First Victor", then the "First Victor" decide who the "Second Victor" is.

16. Methods to obtain Victory Points

Players gain Victory Points (VP) through the following methods.

16.1. Standard Scoring

- +1 VP for each dual-core region you own.
- +1 VP for each province you own.
- +1 VP for each colony you own.

Only when a Great Power has its core in a dual-core region, may they legally own the region. For example, both France and Germany may own Metz.

16.2. Great Power Exclusive Objectives

Great Powers may accomplish goals from their mission cards or VP Board to seize more VPs. VPs from mission cards may only be obtained when the cards have been activated.

- Britain:
  For each independent Low Country, namely Netherlands (Amsterdam) and Belgium (Brussels), +2 VP.
  Suez Canal Construction, +2 VP.
  Two-Power Standard: Any two other Great Powers have their battleships less than Britain, +1 VP each round.
- France:
  Suez Canal Construction, +2 VP.
  Parlement Français: For each agenda finished, +1 VP (max 10 VP).
  Napoleon III: For each one accomplished below, +1 VP
  Ally Britain;
  Forces Russia, Austria/AH or Prussia/Germany to surrender;
  Italy is founded.
- Prussia/Germany:
  Having German Leadership but Germany is not founded, +2 VP; Germany is founded +5 VP.
  Platz an der Sonne: Additional +1 VP for each colony. Having most battleships (or one of the most), +2 VP.
  Baghdad Railway: Accomplish a railway stage, +1 VP.
- Sardinia/Italy:
  Italy is founded +5 VP.
  Italia Irredenta: Additional +1 VP for each region owned below:
  Nice, Trentino, Trieste, Zagreb, and Malta.
  Francesco Crispi: For each one accomplished below, +1 VP
  Ally a Great Power who has a higher total VP;
  Forces France to surrender;
  Claim sovereignty over an African Insignificant Power.

- Russia:
  For each independent South Slavic Country, namely Serbia (Belgrade), Bulgaria (Sofia), Croatia (Zagreb), Bosnia (Sarajevo), Slovenia (Trieste), +2 VP.
  Russo-Turkish Wars: Force the Ottomans to surrender, +1 VP. Owning Constantinople, +3 VP.
- Austria/Austria-Hungary:
  Additional +1 VP for each province.
  Having German Leadership, +2 VP.
  Count Andrássy: For each one accomplished below, +1 VP
  Ally Prussia/Germany;
  Plays *World Exposition* as Event;
  Gain ownership of a Balkan region.

Note: For *Napoleon III, Francesco Crispi* and *Count Andrássy*, you will receive 1 VP if you have been allied to the target or Italy has been formed when the mission card is activated. The VP from alliance is permanent, which will not be deducted even if the alliance is broken later.

16.3. Cards

Players may gain additional VP from situation cards and hand cards.

17. Great Powers

In this section, each Great Power's features and playstyle.

17.1. Britain

Britain is heavily dependent on trade and colonies. Most of Britain's income comes from Trade Value in India and Africa, so they must ensure the integrity of it maritime trade routes. After the opening of Suez Canal and *Steamship*, British maritime trade becomes increasingly important. Therefore, it is important for Britain to maintain a sufficiently powerful navy to keep its empire running.

Independence of Low Countries

Britain has no territorial disputes with continental European powers and can sit back and watch, using its power card *Balance of Power* to maintain a balance among continental powers. The only European territories Britain needs to secure, aside from the important stronghold of Gibraltar and Malta, are the independence of the Netherlands and Belgium. The VP Board should promptly record the independence status of these two countries.

Two-Power Standard

After *Steamship* is activated, place the marker "Two-Power Standard" onto the corresponding spot on the VP Board. During the End Phase of each remaining round, Britain must check whether the conditions for the Two-Power Standard are met. If they are, move this marker one step to the right. Over the entire game, Britain can gain up to 8 Victory Points this way.

Middle East and Central Asia

To secure India, Britain has to struggle with France in Egypt and seize both Sinai and Egypt as soon as possible to make sure that the trade route over Suez Canal is free of blockade, so that Britain can obtain potentially more hand cards via *Waterway of Life*; In Central Asia, Britain will arm itself, sending troops to the frontier against Russia at Afghan-Tehran.

17.2. France

France has many ways to gain Victory Points: it can actively participate in continental affairs, expand into Africa using the power card *Colonial Governorate*, or complete the missions given by event card. France may also be the most politically unstable great power – they are left a choice between agendas from parliament and reality, which also makes it difficult for France to steadily gain long-term benefits.

Parlement Français

At the start of Action Phase, France draws an agenda; France may determine whether to finish the agenda this Action Phase to grab 1 VP, or strive for better benefits in the cost of reducing 1 VP. If France has not finished an agenda for the first time, France converts to monarchy and they may redraw an agenda each time.

When France's legitimacy VP goes to 2 or below for the first time, "Commune de Paris" will take place.

Napoleon III

When France meets any of the conditions on this card, they can gain extra bonus VP. If the condition met is forcing an enemy to surrender, then France gets an extra War Winner VP.

Egypt and Suez Canal

After their technology bonus reaches 2, France may construct Suez Canal and competes with Britain. For the Ops invested into the construction, the power who invested the most will take all the VPs from it. France should keep developing their navy forces to take Sinai and even Egypt by chance.

17.3. Prussia/Germany

To form Germany, Prussia should develop its economic and military strength and gain advantages by acquiring key cards, such as *Humboldt Education System*. After Germany is established, it should excel in diplomacy to face fewer enemies, grasp the continental politics, secure its own safety, and expand its territory.

Unification of Germany

There are three key conditions for forming Germany: seizing the German Leadership, owning Metz, and owning Kiel. It is unrealistic for Prussia to rush to the first two goals because Prussia's economic strength is still very weak in 1848. Prussia may annex the German states by gaining Kiel or playing *Iron and Blood*. These states do not provide any Victory Points to Prussia, but they offer a strong economic and military foundation for Prussia's future expansion. After annexing a state, place the corresponding state marker at "German States annexed" section on Diplomacy Chart.

When satisfying the three conditions at the same time, flip "German Leadership" marker to

the other side, officially proclaiming the founding of Germany. Thereafter, the German Leadership cannot be transferred, and the German Unification Track will no longer be used.

A Place in the Sun

After having the first battleship, *Platz an der Sonne* is activated. Place the "Most battleships" marker onto VP Board and track the number of battleships each country has constantly (not just once per round!) to determine which side of this marker is face up. Note that even if Germany has the same number of battleships as another country, it still counts as meeting the "Most battleships" condition.

At the same time, Germany's colony points increase to 2 Victory Points each, including colonies that Prussia already owned before forming Germany.

Baghdad Railway

After formation of Germany, *Baghdad Railway* is activated. Baghdad Railway provides Germany with large amounts of Trade Value and an opportunity to pass through the territories of the Ottoman Empire. However, note that to construct the railway, it is essential to win over potential allies, as the railway may threaten other great powers with colonies in the Middle East.

17.4. Sardinia/Italy

Sardinia in 1848 is far weaker than all other great powers. However, due to its weakness, it will hardly be targeted by other players. Sardinia's unique power card *Machiavellian Diplomacy* allows it to surprise other players in Action Phase and gain more benefits, but this requires the player's judgment and decisiveness.

Unification of Italy

To form Italy, Sardinia needs to own North Italy or make friends with France. After acquiring an Italian-only core region from Austria/AH or annexing an Italian state, move the corresponding region or state marker to "Italian States & core region annexed" section in Diplomacy Chart. After Italy is founded, place the "Italy Founded" marker in the corresponding section of the VP Board. If meeting all the three conditions, Italy will move the capital to Rome and unite the Apennine Peninsula, and then the Italian Unification Track will no longer be used.

Italia Irredenta

After formation of Italy, *Italia Irredenta* is activated and Italy starts to use the corresponding area on VP Board. When Italy owns a region listed in the mission, Italy does not only collect the regional bonus VP but also obtain the extra VP from this mission (flip the "not owned" to "owned" side for this region).

Francesco Crispi

When Italy meets any of the conditions on this card, they can gain extra bonus VP. If the condition met is forcing an enemy to surrender, then Sardinia/Italy gets an extra War Winner VP.

17.5. Russia

Russia has vast territories, a secure diplomatic environment, and a highly deterrent power

card *Scorched Earth Policy* – all of which give Russia ample opportunities to expand outward. Russia can expand its sphere of influence in the Balkans, colonize the Middle East and Central Asia, provided it can ensure that other great powers do not intervene when it attacks the Ottomans.

Emancipation Reform

Before this reform is completed, Russia suffers an economic penalty and a technology penalty. Russia draws fewer cards from industrial production – even if Russia completes the reform, they draw fewer cards then other Great Powers.

When *Emancipation Reform* is activated, Russia flips the "Emancipation Reform" marker on VP Board to the other side, indicating the start of the reform. Each time Russia spends 1 Op, the marker moves one step to the right; for each two steps, the maximum technology bonus is raised by 1, which means that Russia may spend Ops to advance their technology for next level. After reaching 10 points, the reform is finished.

Independence of South Slavic Countries

At the start of 1848, Sofia, Belgrade, Sarajevo, Zagreb, and Trieste are all owned by either the Ottomans or Austria. Russia should record the independence status of these regions and promptly update their VPs from "South Slavic Country" area of VP Board.

Turkey, Central Asia and the Far East

Since *Russo-Turkish War* is activated, Russia may obtain War Winners VP by defeating the Ottomans, and they may even occupy Constantinople.

Via Central Asia, Russia may expand all the way south to the borders of India or even swallow India. Russia may think about how to distract Britain's attention to somewhere else other than Central Asia.

After *Open-Door Policy*, the situation card *Russo-Japanese War* may be played. Russia should do its best to ensure the Suez Canal remains open and that the Trans-Siberian Railway is completed.

17.6. Austria/Austria-Hungary

Thanks to the Congress of Vienna, Austria starts in 1848 with the highest Victory Points. However, the situation card *Springtime of the Peoples* will greatly shake Austria's political stability. Austria is surrounded by enemies on multiple fronts, forcing the player to manage diplomatic relations with neighbors carefully to progress smoothly through the game.

Austria/Austra-Hungary may use the power card *Multi-ethnic Armies* to add reservists to compensate their weakness on fewer core industry, despite this power card has its limitation on the number of reservists. Moreover, the fact that reservists are weak in battle cannot be ignored.

German Leadership

Although Austria cannot form Germany, it can firmly hold onto German Leadership to prevent Prussia from forming Germany. Once Austria loses German Leadership war to Prussia, the "German Leadership" marker should be handed over. If Prussia forms Germany, Austria can never regain the leadership.

However, Austria may take a quick action to seize Kiel or Metz, then they may have more mobilizable armies (higher Industry Cap as well) by annexing some German states. Or Austria

may maintain their Industry Cap by defending North Italy.
If Austria/AH satisfies the three conditions on German Unification Track before Prussia, then the track will no longer be used (Prussia can never form Germany).

Formation of Austria-Hungary

The mission card *Local Autonomy* gives Austria the opportunity to form Austria-Hungary. Austria-Hungary can mobilize both German and Hungarian Industry to army units. After forming Austria-Hungary, remove the "Budapest" province marker from the game (it becomes AH's core region and will never revolt), then flip the "Cluj" province marker and place it in the "Dual-core region" area. Of course, Austria may choose not to form Austria-Hungary. If it does so, Austria retains a higher regional bonus VP.
On the other hand, Austria/AH may apply influences on Minor Powers, to expand their territories and ensure the stability of Balkan regions.

Count Andrássy

When Austria-Hungary meets any of the conditions on this card, they can gain extra bonus VP. Note that if Austria-Hungary initiate a contest and the contest escalates into a war, they lose this card. Therefore, Austria-Hungary may use influences and diplomacy to acquire more Balkan regions.

18. Game Setup (1848, Round 1)

Before Round 1, set up the markers according to the instructions.

18.1. Ownership of Regions

Put "Own" markers and regional bonus markers (including States) on Main Map as follows:

Great Powers

Britain:

- **Europe:** All British core regions, Ireland, Gibraltar, Malta
- **Asia:** India
- **Africa:** South Africa

France:

- **Europe:** All French-only core regions, Metz
- **Africa:** Algeria

Prussia:

- **Europe:** Berlin, Silesia, Cologne, Königsberg, Danzig

Sardinia:

- **Europe:** Turin, Nice

Russia:

- **Europe:** All Russian core regions, Helsinki, Riga, Vilnius, Warsaw, Chisinau
- **Asia:** Georgia, Ural, Kazakh

Austria:

- **Europe:** Vienna, Trentino, Milan, Venice, Trieste, Zagreb, Budapest, Cluj, Prague, Krakow

Major Powers

Ottoman:

- **Europe:** All Turkish core regions, Sofia, Tirana, Belgrade, Sarajevo, Bucharest
- **Asia:** Armenia, Syria, Baghdad, Basra, Jordan, Sinai
- **Africa:** Libya, Egypt

Turn Ottoman's regional bonus markers to the side "province" or "colony", and place them at the block "Ottoman's non-core region".

Denmark:

- **Europe:** Copenhagen, Kiel

Minor Powers

Greece: Athens

Netherlands: Amsterdam

Belgium: Brussels

German States: Hanover, Saxony, Baden, Bavaria

Italian States: Tuscany, Rome, Sicily

The German and Italian states are separate but independent Minor Powers, each owning one region.

Insignificant Powers

The countries in Asia and Africa that are not colonized by European powers are all independent.

18.2. Influence

Senegal: France 1

Nigeria: Britain 1

18.3. Army Deployment

18.3.1. Europe

According to the local Industry Cap, deploy **conscripts** in regions below:

Constantinople: 3 Turkish

Ankara: 2 Turkish

Izmir: 1 Turkish

Adana: 1 Turkish

Copenhagen: 1 Danish

Athens: 1 Greek

Amsterdam: 2 Dutch

Belgium: 2 Belgian

Besides, place a local Industry in each State below. States have no units:

German States: Hanover, Leipzig, Stuttgart, Munich
Italian States: Florence, Rome, Naples

18.3.2. Africa & Asia

Deploy **Neutral Units** in Africa and Asia:
Africa (North Africa)
Morrocco: 1
Tunisia: 1
Libya: 1
Egypt: 2

Africa (Sub-Saharan Africa)
Ethiopia: 2

Asia (Central Asia)
Afghan: 1
Punjab: 2
Turkmen: 1
Mashhad: 1
Tabriz: 2
Tehran: 2
Kerman: 1
Armenia: 1
Baghdad: 1

Asia (China)
Beijing: 1
Manchuria: 1
Guangzhou: 1

18.4. Navy Deployment

Britain:

- London: 1 Battleship, 1 Frigate
- Malta: 1 Battleship, 1 Frigate
- India: 1 Frigate

France:

- Marseille: 1 Battleship, 1 Frigate
- Nantes: 1 Frigate

Russia:

- Sevastopol: 1 Battleship, 1 Frigate
- St Petersburg: 1 Frigate

Austria:

- Trieste: 1 Frigate

Prussia and Sardinia have no warships.

18.5. Main Map Markers

Suez Canal, Kiel Canal and Trans-Siberian Railway are not constructed.
Forts are constructed in Leon, Cologne, Sevastopol, and Gibraltar.
Put "Defend India" in the box besides India, and put "Support Asian Powers" in the box besides Urals. At the start of each round, reset the status of these two markers.

18.6. Economy Board

Britain:

- Industry Value: 1 Dublin, 7 British
- Battleships: 2 Industry, 6 in Reserve
- Trade Value Counter: 2

France:

- Industry Value: 9 French
- Battleships: 1 Industry, 3 in Reserve
- Trade Value Counter: 2

Prussia:

- Industry Value: 1 Polish, 6 German
- Battleships: 0 Industry, 6 in Reserve
- Trade Value Counter: 0

Sardinia:

- Industry Value: 2 Italian
- Battleships: 0 Industry, 4 in Reserve
- Trade Value Counter: 0

Russia:

- Industry Value: 1 Helsinki, 1 Riga, 2 Polish, 9 Russian
- Battleships: 1 Industry, 3 in Reserve
- Trade Value Counter: 2

Austria:

- Industry Value: 1 Zagreb, 1 Trieste, 2 Italian, 2 Prague, 1 Polish, 2 Hungarian, 4 (Austrian) German
- Battleships: 0 Industry, 2 in Reserve
- Trade Value Counter: 0

18.7. VP Board

- Britain:
    - Independence of Low Country: Belgium and Netherlands are independent
    - *Two-Power Standard*: not started
    - Province: Dublin, Gibraltar, Malta

        - Colony: South Africa, India
    - France:
        - *Parlement Français*: Republic, Legitimacy 5VP
        - Dual-core region: Metz
        - Colony: Algeria
    - Prussia:
        - Province: Danzig
    - Sardinia:
        - Italy founded: not founded
        - Dual-core region: Nice
    - Russia:
        - *Emancipation Reform*: not started
        - Independence of South Slavic Country: All five countries are not independent
        - Province: Helsinki, Vilnius, Riga, Warsaw, Chisinau
        - Colony: Georgia, Ural, Kazakh
    - Austria:
        - German Leadership: has German Leadership
        - Austria-Hungary founded: not founded
        - Dual-core region: Trentino
        - Province: Milan, Venice, Trieste, Zagreb, Budapest, Cluj, Prague, Krakow

Place “Action Turn” marker in “Action Status” for each Great Power.

18.8. Other maps and charts

18.8.1. Trade Value from China

Put all Great Powers’ “Trade Value from China” at 0.

18.8.2. Diplomacy Chart

Put “War of German Leadership – Counter” at “Draw”.
German Unification Track:

- Put “German Unification – Prussia/Germany” at 0.
- Put “German Unification – Austria/AH” at 1.

Italian Unification Track:

- Put “Italian Unification – Sardinia/Italy” at 0.

18.8.3. Technology

Put all Great Powers’ “Command” at 0;
Put all Great Powers’ “Bonus” at 0.

18.8.4. Total VP

Britain: 9VP
France: 7VP
Prussia: 1VP
Sardinia: 1VP
Russia: 8VP
Austria: 19VP

18.8.5. Progress track

Baghdad Railway: Put "Stage 1" at Berlin node. Put "Stage 2" and railway VP marker at Constantinople node.
Suez Canal: Put Britain's, France's and Total progress marker at 0. Put Suez Canal construction bonus at 7.
African Colonial Disputes: Put progress marker at 0.

18.9. Cards

For the situation cards and hands cards with "1848 (aside)" on their card top, they should be placed aside. The rest of them should either make up the situation cards or hand cards.
Distribute mission cards to Great Powers according to which they belong to. All of them have not yet been activated.

19. Game Setup (1872, Round 5)

Before Round 5, set up the markers according to the instructions.
At the start of the game, a war is taking place. Put a Russia's "War Goal" at Sofia. During this war:

- Russia may move their army units across the regions controlled by Romania (but cannot stay there). This is considered a support from Romania.
- Ottoman has deployed Neutral Units in their European regions, remove them when those regions become independent.

19.1. Ownership of Regions

Put "Own" markers and regional bonus markers on Main Map as follows:
Great Powers
Britain:

- **Europe:** All British core regions, Ireland, Gibraltar, Malta
- **Asia:** India, Punjab
- **Africa:** South Africa, Nigeria

France:

- **Europe:** All French-only core regions, Nice
- **Africa:** Algeria, Senegal

Germany:

- **Europe:** All Germany-only core regions (except Vienna), Kiel, Metz, Danzig
  Note: As Stuttgart and Munich are South German regions, you may put "Own" markers there for distinction.

Italy:

- **Europe:** All Italian-only core regions

Russia:

- **Europe:** All Russian core regions, Helsinki, Riga, Vilnius, Warsaw, Chisinau
- **Asia:** Georgia, Azerbaijan, Ural, Kazakh, Uzbek

Austria:

- **Europe:** Vienna, Trentino, Trieste, Zagreb, Budapest, Cluj, Prague, Krakow

Major Powers

Ottomans:

- **Europe:** All Turkish core regions, Sofia, Tirana, Sarajevo
- **Asia:** Armenia, Syria, Baghdad, Basra, Jordan, Sinai
- **Africa:** Libya, Egypt

Turn Ottoman's regional bonus markers to the side "province" or "colony", and place them at the block "Ottoman's non-core region".

Denmark:

- **Europe:** Copenhagen

Romania:

- **Europe:** Bucharest

Minor Powers

Greece: Athens
Netherlands: Amsterdam
Belgium: Brussels
Serbia: Belgrade

Insignificant Powers

The countries in Asia and Africa that are not colonized by European powers are all independent.

19.2. Influence

Tunisia: France 1, Italy 1
Madagascar: France 1
Congo: France 1
Cameroon: Germany 2
Mali: France 2
Afghan: Britain 1, Russia 1

Somalia: Britain 1, Italy 1

19.3. Army Deployment

19.3.1. Europe

According to the local Industry Cap, deploy **conscripts** in regions below:
Constantinople: 3 Turkish
Ankara: 2 Turkish
Izmir: 1 Turkish
Adana: 1 Turkish
Copenhagen: 1 Danish
Athens: 1 Greek
Amsterdam: 2 Dutch
Belgium: 2 Belgian
Bucharest: 2 Romanian
Belgrade: 1 Serbian

Deploy a **Neutral Unit** in Sofia.

19.3.2. Africa & Asia

Deploy **Neutral Units** in Africa and Asia:
Africa (North Africa)
Morrocco: 1
Tunisia: 1
Libya: 1
Egypt: 2

Africa (Sub-Saharan Africa)
Ethiopia: 2

Asia (Central Asia)
Afghan: 1
Punjab: 2
Turkmen: 1
Mashhad: 1
Tabriz: 2
Tehran: 2
Kerman: 1
Armenia: 1
Baghdad: 1

19.4. Naval Deployment

Britain:

- London: 2 Battleship, 2 Frigates
- Malta: 1 Battleship, 1 Frigate
- India: 1 Frigate

France:

- Marseille: 1 Battleship, 2 Frigates
- Nantes: 1 Battleship, 1 Frigate

Germany:

- Kiel: 1 Frigate

Italy:

- Venice: 1 Battleship, 1 Frigate

Russia:

- Sevastopol: 1 Frigate
- Saint Petersburg: 1 Battleship, 1 Frigate

Austria-Hungary:

- Trieste: 1 Frigate

19.5. Main Map Markers

Suez Canal is constructed; Kiel Canal and Trans-Siberian Railway are not constructed.
Forts are constructed in Leon, Cologne, Krakow, and Gibraltar.
Italy's new capital is Rome.
+2 Industry Cap: London, Paris, Prague, Berlin
+1 Industry Cap: Leipzig, Hanover, Cologne, Rome
+2 Trade Value: India
Put "Defend India" in the box besides India, and put "Support Asian Powers" in the box besides Urals. At the start of each round, reset the status of these two markers.

19.6. Economy Board

Britain:

- Industry Value: 1 Dublin, 8 British
- Battleships: 3 Industry, 5 in Reserve
- Trade Value Counter: 10

France:

- Industry Value: 10 French
- Battleships: 2 Industry, 2 in Reserve
- Trade Value Counter: 3

Germany:

- Industry Value: 1 Polish, 15 German
- Battleships: 0 Industry, 6 in Reserve
- Trade Value Counter: 0

Italy:

- Industry Value: 7 Italian
- Battleships: 1 Industry, 3 in Reserve
- Trade Value Counter: 0

Russia:

- Industry Value: 1 Helsinki, 1 Riga, 2 Polish, 9 Russian
- Battleships: 1 Industry, 3 in Reserve
- Trade Value Counter: 4

Austria-Hungary:

- Industry Value: 1 Zagreb, 1 Trieste, 4 Prague, 1 Polish, 2 Hungarian, 4 (Austrian) German
- Battleships: 0 Industry, 2 in Reserve
- Trade Value Counter: 0

19.7. VP Board

- Britain:
    - Independence of Low Country: Belgium and Netherlands are independent
    - *Two-Power Standard*: not started
    - Province: Dublin, Gibraltar, Malta
    - Colony: South Africa, India, Punjab, Nigeria
    - Extra Bonus VP: War Winner +2VP
- France:
    - *Parlement Français*: Republic, Legitimacy 2VP (Commune de Paris has been triggered already)
    - Dual-core region: Nice
    - Colony: Algeria, Senegal
    - Extra Bonus VP: War Winner +4VP, Construct Suez Canal +2VP, Napoleon III (Italy is founded) +1VP, Revanchism -2VP
- Germany:
    - Germany founded: founded
    - Annexed German States: Hannover, Leipzig, Stuttgart, Munich
    - Dual-core region: Metz, Kiel
    - Province: Danzig
    - Extra Bonus VP: War Winner +2VP
- Italy:
    - Italy founded: founded
    - Annexed Italian States: Milan, Venice, Florence, Rome, Naples
    - *Italia Irredenta*: All regions are not owned
    - Extra Bonus VP: War Winner +2VP
- Russia:
    - *Emancipation Reform*: End (Completed)
    - Independence of South Slavic Country: Serbia is independent
    - Province: Helsinki, Vilnius, Riga, Warsaw, Chisinau

        - Colony: Georgia, Azerbaijan, Ural, Kazakh, Uzbek
- Austria:
    - Austria-Hungary founded: founded
    - Dual-core region: Trentino, Cluj
    - Province: Trieste, Zagreb, Prague, Krakow
    - Extra Bonus VP: War Winner +1VP

Place “Action Turn” marker in “Action Status” for each Great Power.

19.8. Other maps and charts

19.8.1. Trade Value from China

Put all Great Powers’ “Trade Value from China” at 0.

19.8.2. Diplomacy Chart

Truce:

- France and Germany.

War of German Leadership, German Unification Track and Italian Unification Track will not be used anymore in this game.

19.8.3. Technology

Put all Great Powers’ “Command” at 0;
Britain and France’s “Bonus” is 2. Germany’s “Bonus” is 1. Other Great Power’s “Bonus” is 0. Bonus points also influence VP and Industry Cap.

19.8.4. Total VP

Britain: 15VP
France: 12VP
Germany: 11VP
Italy: 7VP
Russia: 12VP
Austria-Hungary: 11VP

19.8.5. Progress track

Baghdad Railway: Put “Stage 1” at Berlin node. Put “Stage 2” and railway VP marker at Constantinople node.
Suez Canal: Put Britain’s progress at 0, France’s and Total progress marker at 7. Action 1 is unavailable, and Action 2 is available.
African Colonial Disputes: Put progress marker at 0.

19.9. Cards

Remove situation cards and hand cards without “1872” on card top. The situation cards and hands cards with “1872 (aside)” should be placed aside. The rest of them should either make up the situation cards or hand cards.

Distribute mission cards to Great Powers according to which they belong to.
Remove: *Napoleon III, Emancipation Reform*
Being activated: *Local Autonomy, Russo-Turkish Wars, Italia Irredenta, Count Andrássy, Waterway of Life, Parlement Français, Baghdad Railway*
Not activated: *Two-Power Standard, Platz an der Sonne, Francesco Crispi*

20. Extra rules for playing the game by multiple players

20.1. Recommended Allocations for Fewer Players

Although this board game is designed for 6 players, it can also be played with 2-5 players. In such cases, after each player chooses their country, the rest of the countries not chosen will be seen as Major Powers (like the Ottoman Empire) instead of Great Powers.

For a more balanced and better game experience, the following allocations are recommended:

- 5-player game
  Remove Sardinia/Italy
- 4-player game
  Remove Sardinia/Italy, and then choose 4 from the rest of the Great Powers to play
- 3-player game
  Remove Sardinia/Italy, and then choose 3 from the rest of the Great Powers to play
- 2-player game
  Combination 1: Britain, Russia (Great Game in Central Asia)
  Combination 2: Britain, Prussia/Germany (Naval Competition)
  Combination 3: Britain, France (Colonization Race)
  Combination 4: Prussia/Germany, Austria/AH (German Leadership)
  Combination 5: Austria/AH, Russia (Balkan Problem)

Note that when there are only 2 or 3 players in the game, the rule of the “Second Victor” does not apply, and the it only requires 25VP to seize the victory.

20.2. Extra Rules for fewer players

For Great Powers that are removed, the following actions should be taken:

- Remove all their VP Boards and Economy Boards. Remove their markers on progress tracks and VP tracks. Remove their mission cards and influences.
- Place their "Own" markers at certain regions on the main map, according to the setting of the scenario. Put together their "Province" and "Colony" markers aside for backup.
- Place their Conscripts at certain regions, according to the local Industry Cap illustrated by the main map and the scenario setting.
- Place their warships in certain regions, as illustrated by the scenario setting. These ships will not enter any sea zones but impose limitations when their enemies try to launch an amphibious assault. When their ports are controlled by their enemies, the ships in these ports will directly be destroyed, and they will not be rebuilt.

During the game, make sure that:

- These countries follow the same rule as Major Powers. However, when realizing the regional demands against these powers, the demands cannot be illegal (they are considered Great Power in this circumstance).
- A Great Power may propose a war goal on capital to this country – "Overthrow government".

  Overthrow Government: Force it to be the puppet state of the Great Power, that this Major Power's Independence is guaranteed by the Great Power, and the Great Power can make their puppet state join in their own war (with the puppet state's Support/Against marker).

  When this war goal successfully realizes, add an "Alliance" marker for the Great Power and their puppet state in Diplomacy Track to mark their diplomatic relationship.

  In addition, there are limitations for this special war goal:

  - "Overthrow Government" can only be demanded by the Great Power who claims it. When no war goal on the capital is claimed, this demand cannot be realized.
  - A puppet state's government can be overthrown again by another Great Power. If the demand is realized, cancel the diplomatic relation of this Major Power, and then establish the new diplomatic relation between this Major Power and its master.
  - Every time when "Overthrow Government" is demanded successfully, this Major Power withdraws from all the ongoing war engaged.
- These powers have no hand cards, and they cannot play cards either. They cannot interact with players via hand cards (e.g. draw or discard cards). However, players may influence these powers' units, regional ownership and regional control by playing hand cards.

20.3. Recommended Rules for In-person Play

This board game encourages maximum interaction among players and is therefore ideal for

in-person play. However, the following rules are recommended for in-person sessions:

a) During the Diplomacy Phase, secret diplomacy is allowed: 2-3 players may temporarily leave the table to communicate in a private space where others cannot overhear; secret diplomacy is prohibited in all other phases. It is also advisable to set a time limit for each secret diplomacy session, recommended to be 2 minutes.
b) Do not reveal your hand cards at any point during the game, though you may share information about them (i.e., "table talk" is permitted).
c) Try to abide by verbal agreements (gentlemen's agreements), which will make you more elegant. However, wordplay and ambiguity in diplomacy are highly encouraged.
d) If markers for Industry/Armies, ownership of regions, or bonus VP from events are in short, homemade markers can be used as substitutes.

21. Designer's Note

I have always been fascinated by modern history, especially the period from the mid-19th to the early 20th century – a time of unparalleled grandeur in human history. World-transforming technological innovations, great and legendary figures, flourishing ideologies, the interplay of diplomatic maneuvering among great powers and the surge of national independence movements all endow this era with immense charm. Above all, I am captivated by the wisdom of statesmen who navigated the treacherous political landscape with finesse.
Before creating this board game, I played numerous wargames (including video games) and Eurogame, most notably *Victoria* series and *Here I Stand*. However, I noticed a gap in the market – a board game that can truly immerse players in the art of diplomacy. With my knowledge of history and game theory, I set out to create this board game.

21.1. Design philosophy – limited warfare

Different from other wargames, *Velvet War* requires your abstinence. It easily reminds me of a sentence from *Art of War*:
The most supreme art of war is to outmaneuver your enemy via strategies; the second best is to undermine your enemy with diplomacy; the third best is to defeat your enemy in field battles; the worst is to besiege cities – besieging cities is always the last resort.
This still works in modern history. From the mid-19th to early 20th century in Europe, it is rare to see great powers directly involved in a conflict. Even if two great powers had a war with each other, it usually ended so quickly due to other great powers' intervention.
The chancellor of German Empire, Otto von Bismarck, excelled at leveraging "limited warfare". He did not completely crush Austrian Empire, but made peace with Austria immediately after the Austro-Prussian War, which only lasted for seven weeks; he did not punish the French so hard even the German armies had pushed into the heartland of France, but gave them an opportunity to recover. Bismarck knew for sure that a power showing off its military strength will never bring it good consequences, as a hostile coalition may rise from other powers.
On the other hand, a long-lasting war will do harm to a nation's economy, so it is never wise to use military strength if you can resolve a problem with strategy or diplomacy (even letting

others die for you). In this board game, both mobilization and building warships will reduce your income in the future. In contrast, however, it is sometimes necessary to maintain a grand army as a backing in diplomacy. Therefore, to threaten others with military strength, you must manage to make your opponent believe that you will truly deal with the issue with military power.

21.2. Game theory

I majored in economics at university, and my work was relevant to economics. Game theory is not my research field, but its courses left me with a deep impression. In some courses, I designed game theory models and wrote the steps in detail on how to implement the experiments, which is quite fun. When creating this board game, I tried to incorporate more game theory into it.

The most common one, Cooperation Game, has been written in various forms into the mechanism and cards of this game. For example, the competition in African colonization is a Prisoners' Dilemma: Investing influences to fight over a single African region with another player could make both of you lose. If both of you resist not to step back, *Berlin Conference* may take an effect, and then you will face more competitors.

21.3. Replayability

To enhance the replayability of this game, I mainly focus on two aspects: introducing randomness and high flexibility.

Situation cards are highly associated with randomness. You might have a detailed plan for the next few rounds, like whom to ally and whom to fight; However, a situation card may raise an entirely new conflict – your allies may be hostile to each other (like what Austria and Russia did in history). You may have to choose a side and make peace with your former enemy.

To keep a high flexibility, I simplify diplomacy. You will not see the likewise mechanism in *Imperial Elegy* here, that weak powers are tied to a set of great powers as potential allies with a fixed priority rank (*Imperial Elegy* did an impressive job in historical simulation, and I also partially referred to its map design and mechanism). I wish each player to make their decision whether to intervene in a war based on their judgement of the current situation, rather than have me make their decision.

21.4. Historical adherence

I have devoted considerable efforts to historical research, aiming to reconstruct the changes during that period and how these changes drove historical progress. For this, I have reviewed several academic papers.

For instance, the first steam-powered ship was invented by an American in the early 19th century, but it was far slower than the sailing ships. It was not until the 1860s and 1870s that steamships fully surpassed sailing ships in terms of transportation efficiency for ocean navigation.

Another example is that both Belarusians and Ukrainians share an identical status to Russians

in the 19th century – they were not oppressed like the Polish people and the Baltic people. Therefore, it is not reasonable to classify them as separate ethnicities.

Of course, some nuances can be found between this game and history. I have to sacrifice some historical adherence for gameplay.

Take an example. Regions like Macedonia and Montenegro played a vital role in European politics in 19th century. However, it would be redundant to add them to the game, because they do not significantly affect the conflicts among great powers, nor do they add more depth to the game mechanics.

Another one is Trieste, where in 19th century, most people living there were Italian and German, with only a few Slovenians. To highlight the importance of a port city to Austria, and to illustrate the conflict among Russia, Austria and Italy in Balkan Peninsula, I made Trieste as a Slovenian city; it works similar for Danzig, which creates a possibility that Germany is cut off from the west to the east.

These nuances do not result from negligence, but they are served to enhance gameplay and replayability.